

Work-Life Boundary Management Strategy and its Relationship to Job Attraction

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Submitted to the faculty of the Falls School of Business
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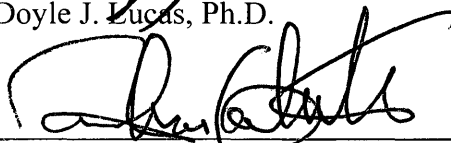
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Abstract

Carla E. Quickel

WORK-LIFE BOUNDARY MANAGEMENT STRATEGY AND ITS RELATIONSHIP TO JOB ATTRACTION

Changing workforce demographics and advanced information communication technologies (ICT) have created new challenges for employers striving to remain competitive. To address these challenges, employers have focused efforts on attracting and retaining quality employees by offering flexible work arrangements. Boundary management strategy (BMS) has emerged as a theoretical framework for understanding work-arrangement preferences and achieving a more effective person-organization fit.

The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a telecommuting work arrangement (TelWA) or a standard work arrangement (StdWA), depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. The data were collected from 144 part-time MBA students from across the U.S., interested in pursuing professional job opportunities in business, through a Qualtrics, LLC. online survey panel. This cross-sectional study employed a 2 x 2 factorial, between-subjects, quasi-experimental design using two-way ANOVA to analyze the data. The results suggested that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. However, the results also suggested that there is less evidence that job attribute (i.e., TelWA)/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was an attribute of the job.

Several possibilities to explain the counterintuitive results were offered including previous telecommuting experience and improved employer guidance and organizational support. Recommendations for practice included a) pre-employment testing for boundary management strategies and b) integrating BMS through structural (job analysis and design, human resource policies) and cultural (supportive supervisors, climate) factors. Suggestions for future research included studying a) BMS as an internal characteristic b) generational differences in BMS and job attraction and c) differences in BMS, telecommuting, and job attraction across industries.

Keywords: Job attraction, boundary management strategy, telecommuting, integrators, segmentors, flexible work arrangements, work/life balance.

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Chapter 1: Introduction

Attracting, selecting, and retaining top talent has increasingly become a challenge for organizations attempting to compete in a more diverse and technologically enhanced world. Recent technological advancements, possessing the potential to create organizational structures that allow greater equilibrium for employees, have ironically created more, not less, complexity and uncertainty (Stroh, 2005). Concurrently, the changing demographics of the modern workforce, with employees' escalating commitments to multiple roles, have generated an increased demand for flexible work arrangements (FWA).

This study examined one FWA, telecommuting, and its relationship to job attraction, and why some job applicants are attracted to job opportunities that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement and others are not attracted. The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a telecommuting work arrangement (TelWA) or a standard work arrangement (StdWA), depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy.

How job applicants manage and experience boundaries between work and personal domains may matter for positive outcomes in attracting applicants to jobs offering telecommuting. The relationship between telecommuting and job attraction and the moderating effect of boundary management strategy was examined. This study sought to answer the research question: *Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction?*

Background of the Study

Societal shifts during the last half century have reshaped the borders of work and non-work relationships (Kossek & Distelberg, 2009). The advancement of available digital and information technologies is considered one of the major causes for the changing nature of work (Kok, 2016). Additionally, a changing workforce with greater numbers of dual-career couples, women, and the sandwiched who care for both children and longer living elders (Council of Economic Advisors, 2014) are among the factors that have precipitated employees' desire for flexible workplace benefits. Recognized as vital to help employees manage work and non-work responsibilities, flexible work arrangements have become an important organizational strategy (Allen, Johnson, Kiburz, and Shockley, 2013). These family-friendly policies are intended to attract people to the organization and help current employees manage multiple roles (Rothbard, Phillips, & Dumas, 2005). FWA's are defined as work options that permit flexibility in terms of "where" work is completed and/or "when" work is completed (Rau & Hyland, 2002). Job attraction is defined as the likelihood that a job applicant will accept an offer of employment.

Organizational goals of family-friendly programs include attracting new employees, improving employee retention, reducing employee stress, and increasing productivity (Sutton & Noe, 2005). Key findings of a 2012 Society of Human Resource Management (SHRM) survey indicate C-suite executives cite the biggest challenges facing HR executives over the next ten years are retaining and rewarding the best employees and attracting the best people. Providing flexible work arrangements was identified as the most effective tactic to meet these challenges (SHRM, 2012, p.2).

Telecommuting, a flexible work/life benefit made possible for a broader segment of the labor force through improvements in information and communications technology (ICT), has commonly been viewed as a solution to attract job applicants (Allen, Golden & Shockley, 2013). Although telecommuting has been around for more than a century, the term was not coined until the seventies by Jack Nilles (1975), when the practice became customary. Gaining popularity through the decades, telecommuting has become the most frequently offered flexible work arrangement, and is made available in some form by 88% of organizations (Sharp, 2013). Telecommuting has been referred to as telework, remote work, virtual work, working from home (WFH), flexible work, distributed work, and flexplace (Lautsch, Kossek, & Eaton, 2009; Morganson et al., 2010; Bloom et al., 2015). The varying terms can imply differing arrangements in structure and flexibility, however they all refer to work that is done away from the traditional workplace and uses ICT equipment to maintain a presence (Nicklin, Cerasoli, & Dydyn, 2016). After a comprehensive review of the literature, Allen et al. (2013) offer the following definition,

Telecommuting is a work practice that involves members of an organization substituting a portion of their typical work hours (ranging from a few hours per week to nearly full-time) to work away from a central workplace - typically principally from home - using technology to interact with others as needed to conduct work tasks. (p. 44)

Researching the social changes that have impacted modern career trends, Greenhaus and Kossek (2013) identified that employees seeking contemporary careers are more likely to telework and to make career decisions that accommodate their family or personal circumstances. According to the 2015 Employee Job Satisfaction and

Engagement report from SHRM, 55% of employees cited the flexibility to balance work and life issues as a very important aspect of their job satisfaction, an increase of 10 percentage points from the previous year (p. 20). The research results, however, suggest that the effectiveness of flexible work arrangement programs is not unequivocal; individual differences among employees, including preferred boundary management strategies, or the extent to which individuals prefer high integration and high segmentation of their work and family roles, is an area of concern and in need of research (Sutton and Noe, 2005, p. 163). Nevertheless, “research has only begun to examine individual differences that moderate the effect of work/life policies on recruitment outcomes” (Thompson & Aspinwall, 2009, p. 195). There have been only a few empirical studies addressing the topic to date (Casper & Buffardi, 2004; Bretz & Judge, 1994; Honeycutt & Rosen, 1997). According to Casper and Buffardi (2004) recruitment outcomes will be affected by the attractiveness of work-life benefits, and more research is needed to determine how individual differences affect the appeal of these benefits to the applicant pool. The present study examines one possible moderator, boundary management strategy, and its impact on the relationship of applicants’ job attraction to telecommuting.

The terms work-family, work-non-work, and work/life will be used interchangeably in this study. The term “family” is used broadly as it has expanded over the years (Rothasusen, 1999) to refer to not only an individual’s household or kin but also to include people with whom individuals have developed social relationships of a familial type such as unmarried partners and very close friends (Kossek, 2012).

Conceptual Framework

In the beginning.... the earth was unformed and void...and God divided the light from the darkness. And God called the light Day and the darkness He called Night (Genesis 1:1-5). The very first act of the Creation was one of dividing. The biblical story of Creation is an account of the process through which we normally create order out of chaos and distinctions are at the basis of any orderliness (Zerubavel, 1991, p.1). Boundary theory focuses on the ways that people create, maintain or change boundaries in an effort to simplify and classify the world around them (Ashforth et al.2000; Zerubavel, 1991).

Boundary theory, an emerging body of work in the work/life research field, provides a theoretical framework for understanding how people manage multiple roles by focusing on the boundary between their work and non-work roles (Ashforth et al., 2000; Kossek et al., 1999; Nippert-Eng, 1996; Perlow, 1998). Scholars who have applied boundary theory to work-family research have argued that people develop distinct boundaries around work and family domains, respectively (Ashforth et al., 2000; Clark, 2000). The ways that boundaries are enacted may vary greatly. Boundary management strategy is defined by Kossek, Noe, and DeMarr (1999) as the principles one uses to organize and separate role demands and expectations into specific realms of home and work. Researchers agree that individuals systematically differ in the ways in which they seek to manage boundaries between work and family domains (Nippert-Eng, 1996a, Ashforth et al., 2000). These differing approaches are referred to as segmentation and integration of work and non-work roles. Segmentation refers to the separation, whereas

integration refers to the overlap between work and non-work time, artifacts and activities (Nippert-Eng, 1996). High role segmentation exists when the domains of work and non-work are treated as separate; physical space and time have a single purpose and non-work issues are “left at the door” upon entering the work domain (Nippert-Eng, 1996). In contrast, high role integration occurs when “no distinction exists between what belongs to ‘home’ or ‘work’ and when and where they are engaged” (Nippert-Eng 1996a, p. 567). An individual who enjoys having his or her work and family roles integrated would likely appreciate working from home. In the same way that individuals may vary in their desires for either more integration or more segmentation, organizational policies may foster more or less integration or segmentation of work and family domains (Rau and Hyland, 2002).

Some organizational policies may help individuals to strengthen or reinforce boundaries between work and non-work roles, whereas others may help weaken the boundaries between these roles. For example, on-site day care is a more integrating policy because it allows employees to interact with their children at the workplace and may combine commuting time with family time. Flextime, has been characterized as a more segmenting policy because it is a practice that promotes impermeable temporal and spatial boundaries between work and nonwork roles (Kossek, 1999; Rau & Hyland, 2002). Rothbard, Phillips, and Dumas (2005) assert that telecommuting, the focus of this research study, fosters integration of work and home, appealing more to individuals with a preference for an integration boundary management style.

Purpose of the Study and Research Question

This study examined why some job applicants are attracted to job opportunities that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement and others are not attracted. The

purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a TelWA or a StdWA, depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. The central argument is that although telecommuting is a popular employee benefit offered to employees, it is not a panacea; how individuals manage and experience boundaries between work and personal domains may matter for positive outcomes in attracting applicants to jobs that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement. The moderating effect of boundary management strategy on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction was studied. More specifically, this inquiry sought to answer the research question: *Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction?*

Professional Significance and Contribution of the Study

This research will have implications for society, individuals, human resource professionals, public policy, and a growing body of research in the work/family field. Negotiating boundaries and understanding issues of time and space is an increasingly important issue in both the modern organization and family environment (Kellogg, 2001). Nippert-Eng (1996) purports that “the home-work boundary is certainly a pervasive and ... quite problematic issue for most members of our society.” (p. xiv). Cleveland and Fleishman (2005) identify that research in the work/life area is increasingly multi-disciplinary, addressing the needs and health of workers, families, and their organizations.

At a macro level, telecommuting contributes to society as an environment-friendly work-life benefit for organizations wishing to support green initiatives. The

practice has been credited as a potential way to slow global warming by reducing commuters on the road, office energy, office construction, urban heating, and business travel (Global Workplace Analytics, 2016). Decreasing the consumption of fuel by two billion annually and vehicle miles traveled by 35 billion (Green, 2013), telecommuting also markedly reduces the wear and tear on transportation infrastructure (Global Workplace Analytics, 2016).

Moreover, the value of telecommuting has been noticed at a public policy level in the United States with the enactment of the Teleworking Enhancement Act of 2010, Public Law 11-292, requiring that all federal executive agencies establish a policy under which eligible employees can telework. Two of the stated goals of the program are to aid in the recruitment and retention of talent and to help employees better manage work and family roles (U.S. Office of Personnel Management, 2016). Additionally, telecommuting allows organizations to better recruit and accommodate persons with disabilities (Anderson et al. 2001), using home as a “reasonable accommodation” per the Americans with Disabilities Act (Global Workplace Analytics, 2016).

Similarly, much of the human resource management literature perceives FWA’s, including telecommuting, as a beneficial recruitment tool. According to the 2016 Strategic Benefits Survey (SHRM, 2016) findings, more than two thirds of HR professionals indicated flexible work benefits will increase in importance for recruiting highly skilled employees in the next three to five years (p. 19). About two-fifths (39%) altered their flexible working benefits to aid in the recruitment of highly skilled employees over the past 12 months (p.19). When Work Works (WWW) is a national initiative led by the partnership of the Families and Work Institute (FWI) and the Society

of Human Resource Management, to help businesses of all sizes and types become more successful by reinventing their workplaces. The initiative administers the annual WWW Award, which recognizes exemplary employers for creating effective and flexible workplaces to increase business and employee success (SHRM, 2015).

Notwithstanding the promotion of telecommuting and other forms of flexible work arrangements in the public and private sectors, the scholarly literature reveals conflicting evidence as to whether telecommuting is a generally effective way for organizations to assist employees to create work/life balance (Allen et al., 2013; Gajendran and Harrison, 2007). Theoretically, this inquiry is intended to contribute to the body of research on boundary theory and to work/life literature. It has been repeatedly identified that there is a need for the study of individual differences that impact recruiting outcomes. (Thompson & Aspinwall, 2009 p.198; Casper & Buffardi, (2004) p.393; Kossek, Lautsch, Eaton, 2009). Additionally, this research will provide empirical evidence to assist organizations when making policy decisions regarding work/life benefits. Kossek, Lewis, and Hammer (2010) suggest “employers need to adapt to view work/life strategies for integration and separation as a new form of workforce diversity” (p. 8).

Organizations will profit from the knowledge regarding the relationship between telecommuting and job attractiveness. An understanding of how boundary management strategies impact telecommuting policies and therefore job attraction will be important for both strategic and tactical decisions surrounding benefit policies and the recruitment of high quality applicants.

Ashforth, Kreiner, and Fugate (2000) sum up an intended contribution of this study when they wrote, “There is likely an optimal fit between an individual and his or her workplace regarding the balance between segmentation and integration, and organizations benefit with increased member commitment when they provide a workplace that accommodates members’ preferences” (p. 488).

Overview of Methodology

This research was a cross-sectional, quantitative study using primary data. A 2 x 2 factorial, between-subject, quasi-experimental design was employed. The primary stimulus was a two-part electronic instrument consisting of self-report questionnaires and two different versions of a multi-attribute job description, similar to a job description found on a company hiring website for a fictitious firm. Participants were working adult students enrolled in a part-time MBA program. A two-way ANOVA was conducted to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a TelWA or a StdWA, depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. Quantitative results will be presented in tabular, graphic, and descriptive terms. An interaction effect is posited between the independent variable, telecommuting (IV), the moderating variable, boundary management strategy (MV), and the dependent variable, job attraction (DV). The details of the research design and methodology will be fully discussed in chapter three of this manuscript.

Limitations of the Study

This study has shortcomings that should be acknowledged. An experimental use of multi-attribute, recruiting job descriptions for a fictitious company tested respondents’

reactions to scenarios, not real-life situations. Fabricated scenarios cannot capture all the variables that may affect real-life decision making. However, proper design of stimuli and process, allowed some explanation of job attraction.

Additionally, the current sample of part-time MBA students was used because a population of individuals with bachelor's degrees, professional work experience, and who are seeking to improve their job positions was desired. It is possible that the generalizability of the current sample to the greater population may be limited.

Finally, self-report measures are used, which could imply that the assessments are not objective. It would be useful to have data from multiple perspectives for assessing boundary management strategies, (i.e. boss, spouse, and children), however respondents were asked to answer items about private constructs that other individuals could not accurately rate. The measures that were used have construct validity, documented by published literature and have undergone reliability and validity testing by the scale authors.

Summary of the Introduction

Recruitment and attraction of top talent has been identified by organizations as an important organizational challenge in the increasingly competitive global market. Recent advancement in information communication technology, coupled with the changing demographics of the workforce, have allowed telecommuting to become increasingly available and attractive as a work/life benefit. Telecommuting has been viewed by many employees as a means to manage the often-conflicting domains of work and family. Both public and private employers have considered telecommuting a viable work/life benefit to assist in attracting and retaining employees.

Boundary theory provides a theoretical foundation for the argument that individuals vary in their preferences for integration-segmentation of their work/life domains. Telecommuting, considered a flexible benefit that allows employees to integrate their home and family roles, may appeal more to those employees who prefer an integration boundary management strategy. This study has attempted to answer the question of why some employees are attracted to telecommuting and others are not. Through primary research, the relationship of telecommuting and job attraction and the moderating effect of an integration or segmentation boundary management preference was explored. This research will contribute to the work/life research and the gap in the literature concerning the impact of how individuals differ in their selected boundary management strategy and job attraction. This research also provides evidence for the importance of individual differences, specifically boundary management strategies, and the consideration needed by human resource professionals when developing and implementing benefit policies and recruiting tactics.

The literature review in chapter two more fully describes the evolution of the work/family field of research, including flexible work arrangements and telecommuting. Boundary theory and a more detailed description of boundary management strategy will be offered to support the hypotheses that will be presented.

Chapter 2: Review of the Literature

A primary goal of this study is to create research that links the understanding of theory and its development to the application of theory in practice. The following literature review will examine the theoretical base supporting this study, beginning with a survey of the work/life field of research and its origins. This will lead to an examination of boundary theory, the concept underpinning this research. The changes in society that have contributed to the evolution of telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement will also be examined, followed by a survey of the research on flexible work arrangements and telecommuting as related to job attraction. As the empirical research in each area is examined, the focus of the literature review will narrow to the study at hand.

Forty years ago, Rosabeth Moss Kanter (1977) described the relationship between work and family as “the myth of separate worlds” (p. 8). Kanter, in a seminal analysis of the work and family literature, identified that organizations operated under an illusion that work and non-work domains are mutually exclusive. Traditional organizations were designed as if workers had no family or personal demands that competed for their attention during work time. Ideal workers were rarely absent from or late to work and did not allow family responsibilities to encumber their commitment to the job (Williams, 1999). Separation of the occupational and family sectors of society came to be considered essential to the smooth functioning of each institution and to society as a whole. In fact, the dictate “While you are here, act as though you have no other loyalties, no other life” was the principle reinforced by organizations (Kanter, 1977). This separate spheres model, questioned by Kanter, was reflective of some of the early theoretical writings of Marx and Engels (1939) which viewed the relationship between work and

other social roles as inherently alienating. The two roles were seen as having disparate functions - the family meeting primarily expressive and affective needs, while work served instrumental purposes within a competitive environment (Parsons, 1970). This perspective framed work and family issues primarily in terms of how to alleviate workplace interference caused by family responsibilities (Fredriksen-Goldsen, Scharlach, 2001).

Kanter's 1977 monograph set the agenda for the study of the interplay between family and work lives. During the decades that followed, emerging research on work and family was precipitated by changing attitudes toward work, the changing roles of family members and changes in demographics of the population. Sheldon Zedeck's writing, *Work, Families and Organizations* (1992) published in the Industrial Organizational Psychology Frontier Series, called for refinement and development of theory in the work-family field. Zedeck's (1992) collection, published at a time when many corporations were just awakening to the need for greater understanding of work/life issues (Kossek & Lambert, 1995), was important in recognizing that what occurs in the family and what occurs in the work environment, however work and family are defined, directly influence each other (Zedeck, 1992, p.xv). Examining the individual and organizational perspectives on the links between the workplace and family, Zedeck's research studies numerous mechanisms linking work and family.

Mechanisms Linking Work and Family

Mechanisms linking work and family and affecting both organizational performance and family functioning have been identified by researchers both prior to and following Zedeck's (1992) seminal work. Linking mechanisms are defined as a

relationship between a work construct and a family construct, existing only when work and family are conceptually distinct (Edwards & Rothbard, 2000). Work-family conflict, spillover, and segmentation are among those identified as notable theories important for an understanding of the interrelationship of work and family processes (Fredrikson-Goldsen, Scharlach (2001).

Work-Family Conflict

A majority of the work/family literature on linking mechanisms has focused on the work-family conflict construct, defined as “a form of inter-role conflict in which the role pressures from the work and family domains are mutually incompatible in some respect” (Greenhaus & Beutell, 1985, p.77). Work-family conflict is thought to occur when the demands of one role drain the resources needed to meet the demands of the other role (Grandey & Cropanzano, 1999; Greenhaus & Beutell, 1985). Greenhaus and Beutell (1985) wrote an influential review outlining the major sources of conflict between work and family roles, including time-based conflict (i.e., incompatible time demands between work and family) strain-based conflict (e.g., affective spillover from one domain to the other), and behavior-based conflict (e.g., where in-role behavior in one domain is incompatible with role behavior in the other domain) as three distinct forms of work–family conflict and proposing distinct predictors of each (Eby et al., 2005). A few years following Greenhaus and Beutell’s review, in a meta-analysis, Frone et al. (1992) found that job stress, operationalized as heavy workloads, work routines, and responsibilities, was positively related to work-to-family conflict. In a second meta-analysis, Ford et al. (2007) found that time spent working contributed to work-to family conflict, such that working greater hours produced greater work-to-family conflict.

Because of the notion that flexible work arrangements are an effective tool for alleviating work-family conflict, the appeal of FWA has been fueled by the popular press and by policy advocates (Allen, et al., 2013). Despite this recent attention and emphasis given to FWA, empirical studies examining their relationship with work-family conflict have produced inconsistent results. The findings reported in four different meta-analytic studies suggest a wide variation in the relationship between flexible work arrangements and work-family conflict, bringing into question the effectiveness of FWA in terms of alleviating conflicts between work and family (Allen, et al., 2013). Moreover, Allen et al.'s (2013) study indicates that "although the potential for FWA to reduce work-family conflict may be beneficial for work-related outcomes such as productivity and job attitudes (Gajendran & Harrison, 2007) the relationship with work-family conflict needs more evaluation" (p. 362).

Work-Family Spillover

Work-family spillover is defined as "the effects of work and family on one another that generate similarities between the two domains" (Edwards & Rothbard, 2000, p.180). Two versions of spillover have been discussed in the work-family literature. One version describes spillover as a positive association between job and family association; a similarity between a construct in the work domain and a distinct but related construct in the family domain (Zedeck, 1992). For example, Ilies et al.'s (2009) study of the spillover of a work role attitude, daily job satisfaction, on daily marital satisfaction and affect at home resulted in a positive correlation between the attitudes in the two domains.

The second version of spillover describes it as experiences transferred intact between domains, as when work fatigue is displayed at home and inhibits the fulfillment

of family role demands (Eckenrode & Gore, 1990). The emphasis in the literature has been on the association of negative spillover and work-family conflict (Carlson, 1999), however Rothbard's (2005) study found support for both work-family depletion (negative spillover) and work family enrichment (positive spillover). Eby et al. (2005) recommend researchers should expand their thinking about the relationships between work and family domains to include the possibility of both types of effects.

Segmentation

A third linking mechanism, segmentation, is the separation of work and family such that the two domains do not affect one another (Zedeck, 1992). No longer viewed as a natural division of work and family, segmentation is considered an active and intentional process in which people maintain a boundary between work and family (Eckenrode & Gore, 1990). Segmentation requires that all direct and indirect effects between work and family constructs are null, thereby indicating a true lack of causal linkages between domains (Edwards & Rothbard, 2000). Shockley and Allen (2012) assert that "preference for segmentation should influence one's motivation to use FWA". Shockley and Allen cite previous research (Kreiner, 2006) suggesting that when there is a lack of fit between individuals' segmentation preferences and the segmentation supplied by their work environment, stress increases. Thus, when those with strong segmentation preferences use FWA, which allow for greater integration of roles (Rau & Hyland, 2002), there is a misfit between preferences and work environment.

Resource Theory

Resource theory is called upon to explain the segmentation construct in that resources such as time, attention, and energy are finite, and those expended in one

domain are unavailable for other domains (Eckenrode & Gore, 1990). This relationship is imperfect, however, since resources may be shifted among domains other than work and family, such as community and personal activities. For example, in response to increased time demands at work, a person may spend less time sleeping or pursuing hobbies, leaving family time intact. Generally, the negative relationship between work and family resources is viewed as intentional, resulting from resource allocation decisions made by the individual. Unintentional relationships may also occur, as when evening shift work makes it physically impossible to spend time with children during their waking hours or when the intrusion of family problems prevents an individual from focusing attention on work responsibilities (Edwards & Rothbard, 2000). According to Edwards and Rothbard's study, the notion that flexible work arrangements are effective for helping individuals manage work and family responsibilities is based on resource theory.

Roles and Boundary Theory

Everyday life is increasingly mediated through formal roles. Labels such as employee, parent, caretaker, soccer coach, can create conflict when an individual is required to manage multiple roles. Competing demands are the source of inter-role conflict, defined by Greenhaus and Beutell (1985), as "conflict experienced when pressures arising in one role are incompatible with pressures arising in another role" (p.77). Katz and Kahn (1978) characterize a role as "the building block of social systems and the summation of the requirements with which such systems confront their members as individuals" (p. 219-220). "A role cues a certain persona or role identity, with specific goals, values, beliefs, norms, interaction styles, and time horizons. Further,

a role that is typically associated with a specific social domain tends to be circumscribed in space and time, creating role boundaries” (Ashforth et al., 2000 p. 486).

“Boundary theory” is the term that has been given to the body of literature examining the human need to create and maintain boundaries that distinguish and order time, space, specific events, or other related constructs, such as roles, into domains that are meaningful for the individual (Ashforth et al. 2000; Michaelsen & Johnson, 1997; Nippert-Eng, 1996; Zerubavel, 1991). According to boundary theory, individuals simplify and order their environments by creating and maintaining boundaries around their various domains, including work and family (Nippert-Eng, 1996). By delineating domains, boundaries enable individuals to direct their focus to whichever domain is currently salient to them (Rau & Hyland, 2002). The ways that boundaries are enacted may differ greatly: some people tend to keep roles such as work and family separate whereas others allow them to be intermingled (Ashford et al., 2000)

Zerubavel (1991) identified that creating and maintaining boundaries are fundamental to human nature and “we in fact, experience reality as a “space” made up of discrete mental fields delineated by mental “fences” that define” (p. 16). Ashforth et al. (2000), examine the ways that individuals erect these “mental fences” around roles such as work and family. Integration and segmentation are the terms used to describe the ways in which we conceptualize and juxtapose home and work (Nippert-Eng, 2006). They describe the degree that aspects of one domain (work/family) are kept separate from the other domain (family/work) (Kreiner, 2006). Segmentation refers to the separation whereas integration refers to the overlap between work and non-work time, artifacts and activities (Nippert-Eng, 1996b). At full segmentation, role boundaries are impermeable

and inseparable, whereas high integration is characterized by flexible and permeable role boundaries. For example, those who integrate more (i.e. integrators) might display pictures of children prominently in their offices and share family stories with coworkers. Integrators freely discuss work with partners, however, those who segment more (i.e. segmentors) refuse to reveal personal information to coworkers and dislike talking about work with partners (Nippert-Eng, 1996). Likewise, whereas integrators might take extra work home, segmentors would be more likely to complete extra work only in the workplace (Nippert-Eng, 1996b). High role integration occurs when “no distinction exists between what belongs to ‘home’ or ‘work’ and when and where they are engaged” (Nippert-Eng, 1996a, p. 567).

It is important to note that role integration–segmentation falls on a continuum (see Fig. 1), ranging from high segmentation to high integration (Ashforth et al., 2000; Nippert-Eng, 1996).

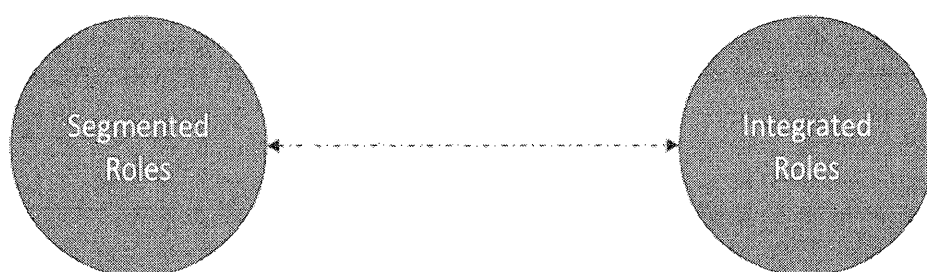


Figure 1: Role segmentation, role integration continuum.

Most individuals fall somewhere between these two extremes (Ashforth, et al., 2000; Kossek et al., 2006)). Nippert-Eng (1996) identified one of the most telling indicators of where an individual falls along the integration-segmentation continuum is represented by the number and type of calendars used. “Because our spatial and temporal maps reflect

our social ones” (Zerubavel, 1985), calendar maintenance reflects how we help maintain a relationship of home and work. Those who integrate realms are more likely to list both home and work events on one calendar and have it available to them at all places.

Segmentors will be more likely to use separate calendars that are realm specific in both their locations and their contents (Nippert-Eng, 1996). While individuals vary in the quantity of segmentation or integration of their varying roles, little is known about why or what predicts whether individuals choose to integrate or separate their work and non-work roles.

Role identification has been one proposed and important element and determinant of integration-segmentation. Ashforth et al (2000), profess individuals are more likely to experience role identification when the person considers the role to be a defining component of himself or herself (Ashforth & Mael, 1989). Ashforth’s work is derived from reinforcement-related research demonstrating that individuals integrate favored roles into other roles. Stryker’s (1980) studies suggest individuals will be more inclined to enact a given role with which they have high role identification because they place high value on that aspect of themselves. For instance, a person who values his or her role as a parent or a physician might be more inclined to integrate those roles into other domains. A more recent study supported Ashforth’s findings; Olson-Buchanan & Boswell’s (2006) research, derived from boundary theory literature, recognizes that roles with which an individual more highly identifies are integrated into other domains by such referent integration as talking about the role, displaying trophies or pictures related to the role, and allowing a favored role to interrupt a role in another domain.

Role Permeability and Role Transition

Ashford et al. (2000) assume that individual preferences for segmentation and integration vary according to the differing and associated costs and benefits. They argue that the costs and benefits could be understood by examining factors including “permeable boundaries” and “role transitions” which determine the degree of segmentation and integration of roles. Permeable boundaries, “allow one to be physically located in the role’s domain but psychologically and/or behaviorally involved in another role” (Ashford et al., 2000, p. 474). An illustration of a highly permeable work to non-work boundary would be an employee checking his or her email and phone messages while away on vacation, whereas an example of a highly permeable non-work to work boundary might include calling to see if the children arrived home from school while waiting for a meeting to begin at work. Olson-Buchanan and Boswell (2006) found that higher work to non-work permeability related to higher work-family conflict, and stress-related outcomes. Olson-Buchanan and Boswell’s work provides empirical support that attending to two domains at the same time leads to blurring of boundaries and ultimately role conflict.

Rau and Hyland (2002) propose that the costs associated with boundary transitions are primarily a function of the degree to which transitions in crossing role boundaries are made difficult or impossible and roles are blurred, causing confusion and anxiety about which role should be enacted at a given time. Ashforth et al., (2000) assume that people seek to minimize the difficulty associated with role transitions, however, once boundaries are socially shared, they can become institutionalized to the point that they are very difficult to change or erase. Further, work and home cultures can

create strong expectations about rules, attitudes, and behaviors that are quite different from one another (Clark, 2000). When these cultures are perceived as contrasting, their members tend to construct a psychological boundary that exacerbates transitions between them (Ashforth et al., 2000).

When roles are highly segmented, there is less permeability between role boundaries and it tends to be easy to create and maintain these boundaries, thus minimizing role blurring and its associated costs. At the same time, however, greater role segmentations mean boundaries are less flexible and roles are highly contrasted. This increases both the difficulty and magnitude of transitions between role boundaries and creates higher transition costs (Rau and Hyland, 2002).

Conversely, greater role integration means boundaries tend to be more flexible and roles less contrasted (Ashforth et al., 2000). Because transitions between roles are less difficult, there are resulting lower transition costs associated with moving between role boundaries. Integrated roles with more permeable boundaries will result in greater role blurring. Integration decreases the impact of out of role interruptions, but creates a greater need for “boundary work” (Nippert-Eng, 1996b) to create and maintain role boundaries.

Boundary Work and Boundary Management Strategy

The term “boundary work” was coined by Nippert-Eng (1996) to describe how individuals engage in the effort of constructing, dismantling, and maintaining the work/home border. Individuals increasingly are finding it difficult to separate from work (or family), unless they actively seek to manage boundaries to do so (Kossek, 2012). Nippert-Eng (1996) defined boundary work as “the never-ending, hands-on, largely

visible process through which boundaries are negotiated, placed, maintained, and transformed by individuals over time” (p. xiii). Kossek, Noe, and DeMarr (1999) hold that a “boundary management strategy” is defined as the principles one uses to organize and separate role demands and expectations into specific realms of home and work.

Kossek, Noe, and DeMarr (1999) assert that a boundary management strategy is part of one’s preferred approach to work/life synthesis. “Everyone has a preferred, even if implicit, approach for meshing work and family roles that reflects his or her values and the realities of his or her lives for organizing and separating role demands and expectations in the specific realms of home and work” (p. 255). Kossek et al. (2005) cite that little research has been conducted on the construct of boundary management strategies, partially because the concept is relatively new in the literature. They argue that people psychologically enact a particular type of boundary management strategy that is partly shaped as a result of the structure of the job they are in and partly by individual differences.

Allen et al. (2014) differentiate boundary management preferences and boundary management enactment (or strategy) as distinct constructs: Integration/segmentation preference is an individual difference variable that captures the degree that an individual favors merging work and family roles (integration) versus favors keeping work and family roles separate from one another (segmentation) (Kreiner, 2006).

Integration/segmentation enactment (or strategy) represents the degree that individuals actually keep work and family domains separate as part of an active attempt to manage work and nonwork roles. For example, segmentors are more likely to enact rules and practices that keep the work and family domains distinct, such as maintenance of separate

schedules for work activities and family activities. Integrators by contrast, would keep work and family on the same schedule (Nippert-Eng 1996). Boundary management strategy is a term that is synonymous with integration/segmentation enactment (Kossek et al., 2006).

Societal Changes Affecting Work/Family Roles

Scholarly and practical interest in employees' boundary management strategies (Kossek et al., 2012; Kreiner, Hollensbe & Sheep, 2009; Matthews, Barnes-Farrell, & Burger, 2010; Nippert-Eng, 1996) and their role effectiveness on and off the job is growing. This attention can be attributed to societal shifts reshaping the borders of work and nonwork relationships (Kossek & Distelberg, 2009). In 1968, 48 percent of children were raised in households where the father worked full-time, the mother was not in the labor force, and the parents were married; by 2008, only 20 percent of children lived in such households (Council of Economic Advisors, 2010). By 2012, over 59% of children lived in a household where all parents work (U.S. BLS, 2013). Women now comprise nearly half of the workforce and there is an increase in the "sandwiched", who care for both children and longer-living elders (U.S. BLS, 2014). Fathers are increasingly involved in caregiving. Greater geographic dispersion of nuclear families is also making it more difficult for employees to have local family support systems (Kossek & Ruderman, 2012). Furthermore, there is an increased percentage of workers pursuing advanced education while working full time (Council of Economic Advisors, 2010).

Younger workers do not expect to have a job for life with one employer and expect customization of working life as part of the social exchange for lessened job security. These generation X and Y workers are much more interested in having more

discretion over when, where, and how they work (Kossek & Distelberg, 2009). “Flexibility to balance life and work issues,” such as the use of alternative work arrangements, was cited by 50% of millennials as very important for job satisfaction (Coombs, 2014). On the opposite end of the age continuum, some older workers want to remain highly engaged in career. Winkelmann-Gleed (2009) found that there was one segment of older employees who work mainly because they enjoy their careers and feel a strong sense of social responsibility to work. This group of older employees especially values a flexible environment as an inducement. “The view that the employee-organization relationship (EOR) is changing has become a truism in both the popular business press and in the scholarly organizational literature” (Shore & Tetrick, 2004, p. 112).

Flexible Work Arrangements

Kalleberg (2001) emphasizes flexibility as a major theme in the literature on work and workplaces. Workplace flexibility is cited as “an organizational strategy undertaken to adapt to changes in product and labor markets” (Shore, Tetrick, 2004, p. 37). Research has revealed that flexible work arrangements are associated with a variety of other important organizational attitudes and outcomes that support the retention, rewarding, and attraction of the best people. A meta-analysis of 31 studies by Baltes, Briggs, Huff, Wright, and Neuman (1999) found that flexible and compressed workweek schedules were positively related to productivity and performance, job satisfaction, absenteeism, and satisfaction with work schedules. Galinsky and Bond (2009) cited research suggesting that during the 2009 economic downturn, U.S. employers began to recognize that the use of FWA can increase retention of their top performers.

Internationally, a recent Towers Watson Global Workforce Study (2012) covering more than 32,000 employees across a range of industries in 29 markets around the world identified that a healthy balance between work and personal life and flexible work arrangements, were among the top drivers of sustainable engagement (Towers Watson, 2012). Some European countries have encouraged flexible work arrangements for more than a decade through a “right-to-request law.” This law gives employees the right to request part-time work, flexible working hours, predictable working hours, and flexible working arrangements (such as telecommuting). As part of the right, employees can expect their request to be considered "in a reasonable manner" by employers. The UK, Germany and the Netherlands have overwhelmingly granted the majority of requests (Siegele, 2017). Similar laws were passed in the US beginning with Vermont and San Francisco in 2013. In 2014, President Barack Obama issued an executive order giving federal employees the “right to request” and in January 2017 the city of Berkeley, CA passed the law.

Flexible work arrangements, referred to as “structural work–life support” (Kossek and Lewis, 2010) are intended to jointly benefit the well-being and effectiveness of employers and employees on and off the job, including their families. However, despite increasing practitioner and scholarly attention and the increased availability of flexible work arrangements, research shows that employees often elect not to use offered policies (Kossek, Lautsch, & Eaton, 2006). According to Kossek and Lewis’ (2010) findings, usually these initiatives are marginalized rather than mainstreamed into organizational systems. Organizational factors that hinder use of flexible work arrangements include unsupportive supervisors, unsupportive organizations, and reward systems that are

inconsistent with use (Allen, 2001). Informal supervisor support for family is a key determinant in whether or not workers have access to formal work/life policies (Hammer et al., 2009). Holt and Lewis (2011) found that even when work policies are well-established, workplace norms that are still based on the concept of “ideal workers who always place work ahead of family” can undermine the utility in supporting a dual agenda of workplace effectiveness and gender equitable work/life integration.

Sutton and Noe (2005) identified that FWA’s are often not utilized because existing programs do not always meet the needs of employees. The “culture of flexibility” has not kept pace with the pro-flexibility messaging in some organizations. Giardina (2014) reports that performance appraisal systems trail behind advancements in flexibility programs with increasing numbers of employers evaluating performance based on facetime at the office versus accomplishments.

Nevertheless, in a study by Shockley and Allen (2012) examining employee motives for FWAs, findings revealed that employees recognized flextime and flexplace (telecommuting) as not only work-family policies that help better management of the intersection of their work and personal life; i.e. balancing work and family, childcare, reduction of commute time, attending to personal matters, but also as a potential means to increase productivity. Furthermore, Shockley and Allen examined individual differences related to why workers use available flexible work policies. It was revealed that employees’ preferences for FWA (for non-work motives) was negatively related to a preference for a segmentation boundary management strategy.

Kreiner (2006) also demonstrated that the congruence between an individual's work-home segmentation preference and the perception of company policies granted to

the individual by his or her organization affected work-home conflict, stress, and job satisfaction. Generally, as workplace policy offerings more closely matched boundary management preferences, a person was better able to negotiate the work-home boundary to his or her liking, reducing work-home conflict and stress and increasing job satisfaction (Kreiner, 2006).

Telecommuting

Telecommuting benefits are a popular form of workplace policy, perceived as appealing to those with a stronger preference for an integration boundary management strategy. (Allen et al, 2015). Advancements in information communication technology, work/life management, and a host of work-related outcomes are among a myriad of factors contributing to the increased interest in and use of telecommuting within the United States over the past several decades. Among the multiple types of FWAs, more research has been conducted on telecommuting and flextime than other forms of family friendly benefits. This research emphasis is likely attributable to their greater prevalence in the workplace, as they are the two most commonly offered FWAs (Galinsky et al., 2008).

Beyond the United States, recruiting firm Robert Half International's recent global survey revealed that Human Resources Directors in 13 countries estimated that 79% allow staff to telecommute as part of their talent attraction and retention initiatives (Robert Half, Singapore, 2012). Towers Watson's (2012) global sample showed those who work remotely or in some kind of flexible arrangement tend to have more positive views and perceptions of their jobs and organizations than their office-bound peers (p.6).

Towers Watson also predicted teleworking will expand even more, especially in industries dominated by highly skilled knowledge workers.

Modern career trends have shown that employees are more likely to telework and to make career decisions that accommodate family or personal circumstances (Greenhaus & Kossek, 2013). Employers believe that telecommuting is a means to recruit and hire high demand/short supply employees. As early as the 1970's private companies such as IBM and Control Data Corporation began exploring telecommuting arrangements to recruit and hire computer programmers who were in high demand but short supply (Avery & Zabel, 2001; Caldw, 2009).

In addition to being a good recruiting and retention policy, telecommuting is positively associated with job satisfaction (Gajendran & Harrison, 2007), organizational commitment (Martin & MacDonnell, 2012), lower work role stress, lower work-family conflict (Gajendran & Harrison, 2007; Sardeshmuckh et al., 2012) and lower risk to physical health (Lundberg & Lindfors, 2002). Explanations for decreased stress include decreased commute time (Cassidy, 1992), relaxed political pressures, fewer interruptions (Olson & Primps, 1984), and employees' perceptions of autonomy over their work. Deci and Ryan (2000) found that in addition to less stress, those employees who perceive more control over how and when work is completed have higher performance and creativity, than when they are controlled.

Telecommuting is negatively related to work exhaustion (Gajendran & Harrison, 2007; Golden, 2006) and turnover (Igbaria and Guimareaes, 1999). In further support of the positive benefits of telecommuting, a longitudinal study by Duxbury, Higgins and Newfield (1998) found significantly lower levels of interference from work to family and

fewer problems experienced by telecommuters in managing family time. Notwithstanding the research cited, the literature suggests that the effectiveness of this flexible work arrangements is not unequivocal. Much of the research on telecommuting has focused on its role in reducing work/family conflict. Gajendren and Harrison's (2007) meta-analysis used intensity of telecommuting as a moderator and found that only high-intensity telecommuting (defined as working remotely 2.5 or more days a week) was associated with lower work/family conflict. Numerous studies have reported increased stress, generally in attempting to balance work and family responsibilities (DiMartino & Wirth, 1990; Olson & Primps, 1994; McCormick, 1992).

McCormick's (1992) study found that more than 70% of teleworking participants reported increased stress resulting from attempts to deal with family issues during work hours. A telecommuter may be expected to be the family member who deals with home-repair workers, daytime appointments, and errands; boundaries may be blurred. Kurland and Bailey (1999) similarly suggested that telecommuting could result in strained family relationships because children and spouses do not respect the boundaries of a home worker's office (Rau & Hyland, 1999, p.113). Hill, Miller, Weiner, Colihan, (1998) relay that some scholars see the flexibility of telework is what employees need to balance work and home responsibilities (Jenson, 1994) while others see the remote office as having the potential to blur the boundaries between work and home life (Jones, 1997).

Interestingly, the first randomized experiment on working from home, studied in Ctrip, a 16,000 employee NADAQ-listed Chinese firm, found a highly significant 13% increase in employee performance, substantially higher reported work satisfaction and a drop in job attrition rates by over 50% for the remote workers. Nevertheless, when the

experiment ended and workers were given the choice to continue working from home or to work at the office, over half of the treatment group chose to return to the office, indicating the extent of employees' learning about their own suitability for telecommuting (Bloom, Liang, Roberts, Ying, 2015).

The conflicting nature of these studies supports Thompson and Aspinwall's (2009) assertion, "when considering the implementation of telework benefits, organizations must realize that despite the advantages of telework opportunities, not all applicants are equally attracted to the chance to telecommute" (p. 205).

This study seeks to determine why some job applicants are attracted to job opportunities that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement and others are not attracted. Research on nontelecommuters has been limited. Koh, Allen, and Zafar (2013) categorized five types of nontelecommuters. Four groups include teleworkers who are not able to make the choice due to reasons beyond their control, such as the organization does not offer it (non-voluntary nonusers). The fifth category includes employees who can telecommute if they want to, but choose not to (voluntary nonusers). The study revealed that employees who chose not to telecommute (voluntary nonusers) reported significantly higher work/life balance than the non-voluntary nonusers groups. However, there is no known published research that includes data on reasons for nonuse (Koh, et al, 2013, p. 254).

As the research on motives for nonuse of telecommuting is scarce, the extent of research on individual differences that moderate the effect of work/life policies on recruitment outcomes is also limited. An early study, explaining individual differences that affect career decisions and job attraction, was conducted by Honeycutt and Rosen

(1997), exploring salient identity. Individuals in three categories of salient identities; family person, career person, and balanced, differed in their job attraction.

In another study, using a policy capturing survey, Thompson and Aspinwall (2009) examined the influence of four work/life benefits on job choice and the moderating effects of two individual differences; internet self-efficacy and gender. Their findings suggested that internet self-efficacy predicted the attractiveness of telecommuting. Rau and Hyland (2002) explored telecommuting and flextime in relation to organizational attraction. Their findings indicated the individual difference, work to family conflict, moderated the effects of both flextime and telecommuting on organizational attraction.

To date, there are no known studies examining the individual difference of boundary management strategy on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction. Telecommuting arrangements permit permeability of boundaries allowing a worker to enact other roles (i.e. the family role), while in the work domain and allowing work roles to permeate the family domain. Compared to StdWAs, where employees spend forty hours each week at the worksite, roles under telecommuting arrangements are closest to the integration boundary management strategy (Ashforth, 2000). Because individuals preferring the boundary management strategy of integration (integrators) favor more permeable and flexible boundaries, it was hypothesized that telecommuting will be more desirable and lead to more favorable recruiting outcomes for jobs that offer a telecommuting benefit.

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space, will have a greater attraction to jobs that offer telecommuting than to those that offer a standard work arrangement (StdWA).

Contrastingly, roles under a StdWA, a workplace practice that involves members of an organization spending 40 hours each week at the organization's central worksite, align more with a segmentation boundary management strategy. Because segmentors erect distinct boundaries between work and life roles, and keep roles cognitively, behaviorally and physically separate (Kreiner, 2006), it was hypothesized that segmentors would respond favorably to recruiting outcomes that offer a standard workweek.

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement (StdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting.

Summary

A review of the evolution of the work/life field of study in the previous pages gives context to the boundary management strategy construct. Research on the work/family interface has grown substantially over the past several decades and a survey of findings regarding linking mechanisms and various theories that underpin the relationship to flexible work arrangements was identified. Literature reviewing the FWA, telecommuting, as a response to individual needs, information communication technology advances, and resulting organizational changes was examined. The strategic choice of organizations to offer work-family policies, specifically telecommuting, in order to attract and retain employees has been established, however empirical studies on how and why employees choose telecommuting have been scarce.

Similarly, the research on individual differences and job attraction has been limited. Literature regarding how boundary management strategy is shaped by both the structure of the job and by individual differences was explored. Based on the theoretical findings surrounding boundary management strategy, hypotheses relating to boundary management strategy and its effect on the relationship of telecommuting and job attraction were proposed.

Chapter 3: Methodology

In chapter two, the theoretical basis for this research study was established, and the results of empirical studies were reviewed related to the following constructs: (a) boundary management strategy, (b) flexible work arrangements (e.g., telecommuting), and (c) job attraction. This chapter includes the design and methodology used to explore the research question and hypotheses. The research perspective, design, research context, participants, sample size, materials, measures, procedure, demographic characteristics of the sample, data analysis, and ethical considerations are presented.

Research Perspective

The topic of this study--i.e., how individual boundary management strategies may influence the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction--lends itself to a cross-sectional, quasi-experimental, quantitative research methodology. This chapter explains the methodological approach that was used to answer the following research question and test the following hypotheses:

RQ: Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction?

H₀ Boundary management strategies have no effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction.

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer telecommuting(TelWA) than to those that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA).

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting(TelWA).

The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a TelWA or a StdWA, depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy.

As illustrated in Figure 1, it was expected that the independent variable (IV), TelWA, would have an effect on the dependent variable (DV), job attraction. The moderating variable (MV), boundary management strategy (integrator or segmentor), was predicted to have an effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction (see Fig. 2).

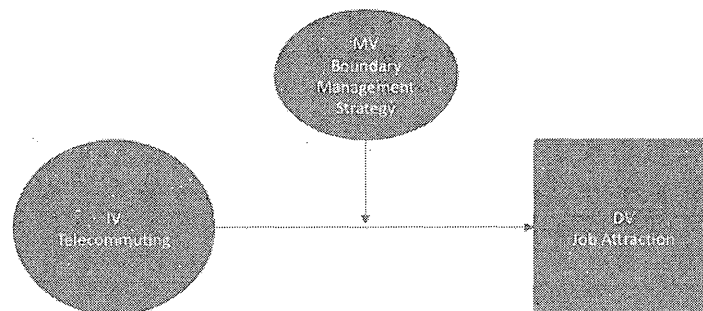


Figure 2. Conceptual model of the moderating effect of boundary management strategy on telecommuting and job attraction.

Design

This quasi-experimental study consisted of a 2 X 2 factorial design, with two levels of two variables. The focal variable, job attribute, was the active variable and was manipulated. At one level of the focal variable, TelWA was present, and at the other

level, the TelWA was absent (i.e., the StdWA). The moderator variable, boundary management strategy, was a characteristic of the research participants and therefore could not be manipulated. The two levels of the moderator variable, boundary management strategy, were defined as segmentors and integrators. The two levels of job attribute were defined as TelWA and StdWA. As a result of these distinctions, four participant groups emerged (see Table 1).

Table 1

Levels of Boundary Management Strategy and Job Attribute

Job Attribute	Boundary Management Strategy	
	Segmentors	Integrators
Telecommuting Work Arrangement (TelWA)	<i>a</i>	<i>c</i>
Standard Work Arrangement (StdWA)	<i>b</i>	<i>d</i>

Research Context

Data were collected with the assistance of Qualtrics, LLC, a private research services company, based in Provo, Utah. After the questionnaire was designed and revised, and after an exploratory study was conducted, a Qualtrics Panel Team identified participants who were incentivized to complete the questionnaire online. The questionnaire was provided in two formats, enabling completion through either a computer or mobile device. Each participant's questionnaire was accessible to the author of this study as they participated and completed it. The research activity, including the pilot study, occurred during a two-month period from April 26, 2017 to June 28, 2017.

Research Participants

The study sample included part-time MBA students enrolled in U.S. colleges and universities. Part-time MBA students are typically non-traditional students with full-time work experience as opposed to traditional students, who often pursue an MBA degree full-time, soon after completing a bachelor's degree. Part-time MBA students were chosen as the sample because they represent the study population: college-educated, working adults, with some level of full-time job experience, seeking to improve career opportunities in the field of business. MBA students have been found to aspire to careers, not jobs or callings (Eddy, Burke, & Fiksenbaum, 2008, p. 364). The desire of MBA students to improve their career status suggested that they might possess a natural interest in reading a recruiting job description as a way of identifying their attraction to a career position. Additionally, the experience of part-time MBA students in the workforce was expected to provide a context upon which to base their level of attraction to a job that offered telecommuting.

Sample Size

A statistical power analysis was conducted to determine the proper sample size as well as the probability of correctly rejecting the null hypothesis, if it should be rejected. Cohen (1988) has provided guidelines for acceptable levels of power and suggested that studies be designed to achieve alpha levels of at least .05 with power levels of 80% (Hair et al., 2010, p. 10). The software program, G*Power 3 (Faul, Erdfelder, Buchner, & Lang, 2009) was used to compute the *a priori* power analysis for this study. Estimating a moderate effect size, .05 alpha level, and .95 power level yielded a recommended sample size of 107.

Exploratory study sample. To establish face validity, an exploratory study was conducted to develop, refine, and test the measurement tools and procedures. The pilot study yielded 42 completed questionnaires from part-time MBA students at a small, private, Midwestern university as well as friends and family members of the researcher. The demographics of the MBA participants in the pilot were expected to represent the participants who later completed questionnaires in the larger study. Using the Qualtrics software, the questionnaire was emailed to 112 part-time MBA students, with an 18% response rate (20 questionnaires completed). An additional 22 questionnaires were completed online by friends and family members of the researcher.

Materials

Experimental materials consisted of a self-report survey instrument containing three distinct sections preceded by an introduction, screening queries, and a consent form. Section 1 included two between-subject job descriptions that provided the context for the treatment variable, a single-survey job attraction item, and a manipulation check item. Section 2 included items designed to identify participants' boundary management strategy, and Section 3 was comprised of 12 demographic items (see Appendix G).

The primary stimuli were two different versions of a multi-attribute, recruitment job description for a fictitious firm specializing in a wide range of management consulting services. A recruitment brochure developed and used by Rau and Hyland (2002), representing a fictitious management services firm, and recruiting ads posted on INDEED.com by current well-known and respected management consulting firms, provided guidelines for verbiage developed for the job descriptions used in this study. The treatment job description listed telecommuting as a required attribute, and the control

job description did not. The telecommuting information was embedded within other information about the organization, designed to make the job description appear realistic. Because the study sample included participants with diverse business backgrounds, the fictitious employment firm was described as a “management services consulting firm” in the job description to increase the attractiveness of the organization to participants from a wide variety of business specialties.

The two levels of the experimental condition were depicted by the presence or absence of telecommuting. To depict the job with telecommuting, the following statement was added, and the telecommuting attribute was highlighted in boldface font: “All consultant positions require telecommuting from home or another remote location a minimum of three days per week. State-of-the-art technology and equipment needed to support telecommuting will be provided and maintained by ABC company and its talented IT support staff.” The job description describing the position with a StdWA did not include this statement. Other than manipulating the TelWA/StdWA, the two job descriptions contained identical information, and were presented in exactly the same format. A randomizer was used to ensure that the treatment and control stimuli were randomly assigned to the participants.

Measures

Job attraction. The DV, job attraction, was intended to assess participants’ attraction to the job and their intentions to accept or not accept the position. Job attraction was measured using Thompson and Aspinwall’s (2009) single survey item. The item appeared on a single page following the job description vignette: “If you qualified for the job described and you were trying to decide among several job offers, what is the

likelihood that you would accept the job described above?” A Likert-type response scale ranging from 5 (very likely) to 1 (very unlikely) was provided (Thompson & Aspinwall, 2006, p. 201).

Manipulation check. To determine whether the manipulation was accurately interpreted by the participants, a manipulation check was run. It consisted of one item intended to determine recall of whether the job description included the independent variable, telecommuting: “In the job description, was telecommuting listed as one of the job requirements?” Participants marked either “yes” or “no” in response to this item. Those respondents who indicated an incorrect response were excluded from the analysis.

Boundary management strategy. Section two of the electronic questionnaire presented a Likert-type self-report scale to determine boundary management strategy. The measure (see Appendix A) was derived by Kossek, Lautsch, and Eaton (2006) and was based on the theoretical definition of the construct of boundary management strategy. The instrument has been commonly used in boundary management studies for measuring overall boundary management strategy (Mellner, Aronsson, & Kecklund, 2014, p. 6).

Kossek, Lautsch, and Eaton (2006) validated this instrument following research procedures illustrated by Zacharatos, Barling, and Iverson (2005) in which measures of individual’s reports of work practice are assessed using a hybrid of Likert and dichotomous items where it would not make sense to use a Likert scale. All items were standardized to z scores. The α for the 12 items was .7025. The factor analysis showed one factor, with an eigenvalue of 2.19 and explains 75% of the variance (Kossek et al., 2006, p. 357).

The scale was used as validated, but minor word revisions were made to two items. Participants were asked to indicate their agreement with 12 items. Nine of the items were measured using a Likert-type scale ranging from 5 (strongly agree) to 1 (strongly disagree). Three items featured a dichotomous response scale. To score participants' responses, the variable was transformed into 1, segmentors (5 strongly agree, 4 agree), 0 (3 neither agree nor disagree) and -1, integrators (2 disagree, 1 strongly disagree). This allowed each respondent's score to be computed resulting in a range of -12 to +12. The variable was dichotomized with -12 through -.001 = 0, integrators and .001 through 12 = 1, segmentors.

Demographic variables. Barber (1998) reviewed a substantial body of research findings indicating that applicant strategies for specific job attributes differ across demographic variables. Because the job descriptions presented information about several characteristics of the job and the organization, it was impossible to predict how applicants of various demographic groups might respond to these attributes. Therefore, in Section 3 of the electronic questionnaire, data were gathered on age, gender, ethnic background, educational attainment, marital status, who lives in home, job status of working spouse and significant other, job status of participant (employed or unemployed), occupation, and whether a previous job with telecommuting was held.

Procedures

Exploratory work was conducted prior to instrument design. Online recruitment ads of existing organizations posted on internationally recognized job boards were examined to ensure that the job description, the primary stimulus, reflected the type of content and style used in current corporate recruitment job descriptions. Although Rau

and Hyland's (2002) recruitment brochure was used as a foundation, significant alterations to wording and format were required to transform it to the online recruitment practices that have evolved since the time when the use of hardcopy recruitment brochures was common.

Following the final design of the primary stimuli, i.e. the two job description vignettes, the online questionnaire was developed and a pilot test was administered to the trial group of MBA students and other associates to determine the face validity of the instrument. Pilot participants were sent an invitational email with a link to the questionnaire and an optional "unsubscribe" link. A reminder email was sent a week later to those who did not complete the questionnaire and did not unsubscribe (see Appendix B, C, D). After completion of the questionnaire, a thank-you email was sent to each participant for their contribution to the face validation (see Appendix E) and an option to receive the study results if interested. The primary intention of the pilot study was to identify potential problem areas and to ensure clarity of the questionnaire items and the vignettes. Pilot participants were asked to provide suggestions through open-ended questions placed at the end of each section:

FEEDBACK REVIEWERS, Section One:

Please share any comments and/or suggestions regarding content, readability, ease of understanding, ease of answering questions, etc. in the previous section.

Forty-one respondents completed the pilot questionnaire, and 17 provided feedback that resulted in numerous adjustments to the questionnaire both in terms of the wording of the content as well as the language mechanics.

The finalized version of the online questionnaire (see Appendix F) was then emailed to a panel of participants identified by the Qualtrics Panel Team. The online questionnaire was delivered to participants across the United States who met the inclusion criteria and were incentivized to participate in the research study. To help reduce the number of invalid responses, a commitment item was inserted at the beginning of the study asking participants to commit to providing high-quality data: “I will give my best answers.” Those who did not commit were screened out of the survey process. Four additional screening items were presented to filter participants who did not meet the inclusion criteria (age 21 or above, part-time MBA student).

The informed consent form preceded Section 1 of the questionnaire where the two job description vignettes were presented. A randomizer was utilized to ensure that the two separate job descriptions (one that included telecommuting and one that did not include telecommuting) were randomly distributed. Each participant viewed only one job description, allowing less opportunity for participants to guess the variable that the researcher was measuring. In a between-subject design experiment, where each individual is exposed to only one treatment, causal estimates are obtained, as long as group assignment is random (Charness, Gneezy, Kuhn, 2012 p. 1). The between-subject design was used to reduce the opportunity for bias and to provide better construct validity. After reading the randomly assigned job description, each participant immediately responded to the job attraction item. Following their response to the item regarding their likelihood of accepting a job offer, all participants were presented the manipulation check item: “In the job description, was telecommuting listed as one of the job requirements?” The manipulation check identified participants who did not correctly

identify the treatment variable. Participants who incorrectly answered the manipulation check were eliminated from the study after the data were collected. In Section 2, the boundary management strategy scale was presented to all participants, followed by the 12 demographic items in Section 3.

Demographic Characteristics of the Sample

The sample consisted of 144 part-time MBA students from across the United States. One-half (50%) of the sample previously worked at a job that included telecommuting. The vast majority of participants (82%, $n = 119$) were employed full time, while a much smaller percentage of participants were employed part time (10%, $n = 14$), and an even smaller percentage were unemployed (8%, $n = 11$) for a variety of reasons--e.g., retired or disabled (see Table 2).

Table 2

Employment Status of Participants

	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
Employed full-time	119	82.6	82.6
Employed part-time	14	9.7	92.3
Not working	11	7.7	100.0

More than half of the participants (62%, $n=89$) reported that they were first/mid-level managers or professionals, and an additional 10% ($n=15$) reported that they were executive or senior officers and managers (see Table 3). Administrative support workers comprised 9% ($n= 13$) of the sample, and service workers and technicians collectively comprised another 5% ($n=8$). In addition to sales workers (3%, $n=4$), the remaining

participants held various other positions, such as construction worker (n=1), craft worker (n=1), and EBay trader (n=1).

Table 3

Occupation of Participants

	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
First/Mid-level Managers and Professionals	89	61.8	61.8
Executive & Sr. Level Managers	15	10.4	72.2
Administrative Support	13	9.0	81.2
Not Working	11	7.6	88.8
Service Workers & Technicians	7	4.9	93.7
Sales	4	2.8	96.5
Other	5	3.5	100

The sample included slightly more females (55%, n=79) than males (45%, n=65). The age range of all participants was between 22 and 78 years, with a median age of 37 years. Almost three-quarters of the participants reported that they were Caucasian (74%, n=107). Hispanics or Latinos comprised 10% (n=14) of the sample, with Asians following close behind (8%, n=11). Seven percent (n=10) of the sample consisted of African Americans (7%, n=10), and Native Americans comprised only 1%, (n=2) (see Table 4).

Table 4

Ethnic Background of Participants

Ethnic Background	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
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Ethnic Background	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
Caucasian	107	74.3	74.3
Hispanic or Latino	14	9.7	84.0
Asian	11	7.6	91.6
African American	10	6.9	98.5
Native American	2	1.4	99.9

As expected in a sample of graduate students, the highest academic degree earned among participants (90%, *n*=129) was a bachelor's degree; however, a much smaller proportion of participants also held master's degrees (9%, *n*=12) and doctorates (1%, *n*=2). Almost two-thirds (62%, *n*= 89) of the participants reported that they were married, slightly more than one-quarter (28%, *n*= 40) reported that they were never married, and a small minority (10%, *n*=15) reported that they were divorced or widowed (see Table 5).

Table 5

Marital Status of Participants

Marital Status	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
Married	89	61.8	61.8
Never Married	40	27.8	89.6
Divorced or Separated	12	8.3	97.9
Widowed	3	2.1	100

A small segment of the sample reported living alone (*n*=19, 13.2%) (see Table 6). One quarter of the participants (*n*=36) reported that they lived with a spouse or significant other, and the majority (56%, *n*= 81) reported that their living arrangements included various numbers and ages of children. An additional small number (6%, *n*=8) of participants lived with others, such as roommates, elderly parents, or siblings. Eighty-

seven percent of married spouses and 100% of live-in significant others reported that they worked outside the home. Additionally, 13% (n=18) of participants reported had elder care responsibility.

Table 6

Living Arrangements of Participants

Lives in home with...	<i>n</i>	%	Cumulative %
Lives Alone	19	13.2	13.2
Spouse or Significant Other	36	25.0	38.2
Children <18 yrs or ≥18 yrs.	81	56.3	94.5
Other	8	5.6	100

The participants were categorized into four groups (see Table 7). The moderating variable (i.e., boundary management strategy) consisted of two groups: integrators (n=40) and segmentors (n=104). The active variable (i.e., Job Attribute), consisted of two levels: StdWA (n=75) and TelWA (n=69). The StdWA group included participants who received a job description indicating that telecommuting would not be part of the job requirement, and the telecommuting group (i.e., the TelWA group) included participants who received the job description with a telecommuting requirement.

Table 7

Counts for Job Attribute by Moderating Variable

		Boundary Management Strategy		
		Integrators	Segmentors	Total
Job Attribute	StdWA	19	56	75

	Boundary Management Strategy		
	TelWA	21	48
			69
Total		40	104
			144

Data Analysis

The data analysis process consisted of several steps. These steps are presented here in a linear, step-by-step fashion. The purpose of presenting the steps in the data analysis is to provide a clear description of (a) the analyses that were conducted, (b) the order in which they were conducted, and (c) the rationale for each analysis.

Step 1: Exploratory Data Analysis

1a: Inspect for Outliers

1b: Check Normality of Data

1c: Check Homogeneity of Variances

Step 2: Conduct Two-Way ANOVA

Step 3: Determine Skewness

Step 4: Apply Square Root Transformation and Conduct Two-Way ANOVA

Step 5: Compare Untransformed Results of ANOVA with Transformed Results

Step 6: Remove Boxplot Outliers and Conduct Two-Way ANOVA with

Untransformed Data

Step 7: Compare Results (a) with Boxplot Outliers and (b) with Boxplot Outliers

removed

Step 8: Remove Studentized Outliers and Conduct Two-Way ANOVA with

Untransformed Data

Step 9: Compare Results with (a) Studentized Outliers and (b) with Studentized Outliers removed

Step 10: Analyze Interaction Effect

Step 11: Conduct Analysis of Main Effects

11a: Calculate Estimated Marginal Means (Unweighted for Unbalanced Designs)

11b: Test Differences between Marginal Means using Pairwise Comparisons

First, reliability was assessed using Cronbach's alpha to evaluate internal consistency of the boundary management scale. Reliability is an assessment of the degree of consistency between multiple measures of a variable (Hair, 2014, p. 125). Cronbach's alpha, the most commonly used measure, is a test of reliability that ranges from 0 to 1, with values of .60 to .70 deemed the lower limits of acceptability (Hair, 2014, p. 92). Next, a two-way ANOVA was conducted to examine the effects of boundary management strategy and telecommuting on job attraction. An interaction effect was posited between the IV (telecommuting), the MV (boundary management strategy), and the DV (job attraction). Hair (2010) stated that ANOVA is particularly useful for experimental research designs in which the researcher directly manipulates one or more independent variables to determine the effect on the dependent variable (p. 346).

This quasi-experimental study design also met the first three assumptions of the two-way ANOVA, according to Laerd (2015, p. 5): Assumption 1: There was one dependent variable (job attraction) that was measured at the continuous level using an ordinal scale. Assumption 2: There were two dichotomous independent variables

(boundary management strategy [BMS] and job attribute). BMS contained two levels (integrators and segmentors), and the independent variable, job attribute (the active variable), included two levels: TelWA and StdWA. The study design also met assumption #3, independence of observations. There were different participants in each group, with no relationship between participants in the groups.

Exploratory analysis was conducted to test for the assumptions of the two-way ANOVA. Outliers were assessed by two methods: (a) inspection of a boxplot and (b) studentized residuals. Normality was assessed using the Shapiro-Wilk normality test for each cell of the design, and homogeneity of variances was assessed by Levene's test. Because the data were not normally distributed and the variances were heterogeneous, a square root transformation was applied, and outliers were removed. The two-way ANOVA was conducted on the transformed and untransformed data as well as with and without outliers. According to Howell (2010), when the results do not indicate a statistically significant interaction effect, it is customary to interpret and report the main effects and, if a main effect is statistically significant, follow up with a post hoc analysis (e.g., all pairwise comparisons). Therefore, main effects and pairwise comparisons were conducted for boundary management strategy, the main effect that was statistically significant.

Ethical Considerations

Approval from the Anderson University DBA Human Subjects Committee was obtained prior to the study being executed (see Appendix G). Permission was also requested and granted from the Ivy Tech Community College Internal Review Board

(IRB) (see Appendix H), which was necessary because the Ivy Tech Community College licensed Qualtrics platform was used to collect data.

Confidentiality of all collected data was rigorously maintained. Anonymity was promised to the participants, and no identifying names or other information was placed on the questionnaire or related materials. A non-identifying code was assigned to each participant in the study sample; however, names and information attached to the code were only available to and held by Qualtrics, which adheres to arduous confidentiality procedures. The identification code was the only identifier available, even to the researcher.

Summary

This quasi-experimental study was conducted using quantitative techniques to analyze primary data collected through an online survey panel. One-hundred forty-four part-time MBA students from across the U.S., interested in pursuing professional job opportunities in business, participated in the research. Exploratory work, including research on current recruiting practices, and a pilot test of the questionnaire, was conducted to ensure that the instruments and methods were clear to participants. Two-way ANOVA was used to determine whether the relationship between the two variables (telecommuting and job attraction) was moderated by the value of a third variable: boundary management strategy.

Chapter 4: Results

According to Gallup's 2017 State of the American Workplace Report, work-from-home opportunities have played a major role in employees' decisions to accept a job. Fifty percent of millennials reported that they would join a new company if they had access to a flexible working location where they could elect to work off-site part-time; likewise, 33% of older cohorts also share this same sentiment (p. 48). Research studies, however, have suggested that the effectiveness of flexible work arrangement programs is not unequivocal; that is, individual differences among employees, including preferred boundary management strategies (i.e., the extent to which individuals prefer high integration and high segmentation of their work and family roles), represent an area of concern that has been in need of research (Sutton & Noe, 2005, p. 163).

The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a TelWA or a StdWA, depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. In order to accomplish this purpose, the following research question and hypotheses guided this study:

RQ: Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction?

H₀ Boundary management strategies have no effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction.

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer telecommuting(TelWA) than to those that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA).

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting(TelWA).

Research Design and Summary of the Method

This cross-sectional study employed a 2 x 2 factorial, between-subjects, quasi-experimental design. The instrument of data collection consisted of three parts. Part 1 consisted of two different versions of a multi-attribute job description for a fictitious firm, similar to job descriptions found on websites of companies planning to hire new employees. Part 2 consisted of a self-report questionnaire containing 12 items that measured boundary management strategies. Part 3 consisted of an additional 12 items designed to collect demographic information.

The study sample included 144 part-time MBA students enrolled in U.S. colleges and universities. Data were collected using Qualtrics, LLC, a private research software company, based in Provo, Utah. Participants who met the inclusion criteria were recruited through an online survey panel identified by Qualtrics. A two-way ANOVA was conducted to determine whether there was a significant difference in applicant attraction to a telecommuting job based on participants' boundary management strategy (i.e., integration or segmentation).

Summary of the Results

After exploratory analyses were conducted, a square root transformation was applied, and outliers were removed using two different methods (i.e., boxplot and studentized residuals), the results suggested that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. However, the results

also suggested that there is less evidence that job attribute (i.e., TelWA)/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was an attribute of the job. The results indicated that the researcher failed to reject the null hypothesis.

Results

The following research question guided this study: Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction? To answer this research question, two hypotheses were tested:

H₀ Boundary management strategies have no effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction.

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer telecommuting(TelWA) than to those that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA).

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting (TelWA).

The data analysis process consisted of several steps. These steps are presented here in a linear, step-by-step fashion (see Figure 3).

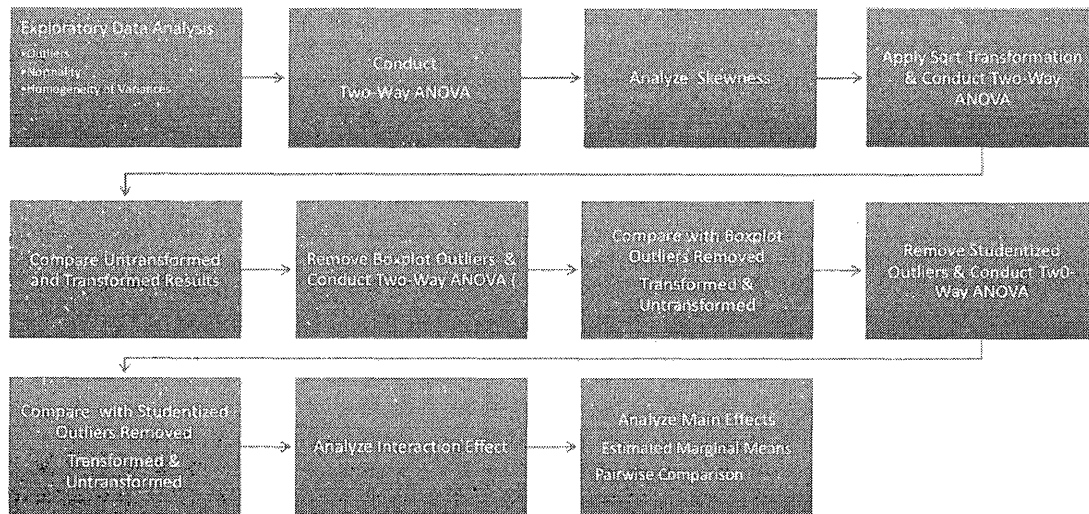


Figure 3. Data analysis path.

First, exploratory data analyses were conducted to determine whether the data met the assumptions of the two-way ANOVA. Normality was assessed using Shapiro-Wilk's normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p = .007$; segmentors $p = .000$) and the TelWA group (integrators $p = .000$; segmentors $p = .000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p = .048$. To investigate the effects of non-normality on the results, and to address inequality of variances, the researcher decided to apply a transformation to the data. Data transformation can be employed to improve the normality of a variable's distribution (Osmond, 2002, p.1) as well as equalizing variance (Bartlett, 1947). In order to determine the type of transformation to apply, skewness and kurtosis were calculated. Skewness and kurtosis coefficients were standardized to z-scores and revealed that the data were negatively skewed (see Table 8). Therefore, because the data were negatively skewed, a square root transformation (Sqrt) was applied. Square-root transformation is commonly used and appropriate for data consisting

of small whole numbers less than ten (Fernandez, 1992), and to reduce right skewed data (Tabachnick & Fidell, 2007) (Howell, 2007).

Table 8

Skewness and Kurtosis

	<u>Skewness</u>			<u>Kurtosis</u>		
	Statistic	St. Error	Z-Score	Statistic	Std. Error	Z-Score
Accept Job?	-1.03	0.20	-5.11	0.77	0.40	1.92
Job Attribute	0.08	0.20	0.42	-2.02	0.40	-5.04
BM Strategy	-1.00	0.20	-4.97	-1.01	0.40	-2.52

Two-Way ANOVA without Square-Root Data Transformation

To test the hypotheses and to examine the moderating effects of boundary management strategy on telecommuting and job attraction, the researcher conducted a two-way ANOVA. The interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1,140) = .983, p = .32$, partial $\eta^2 = .001$ (see Figure 4).

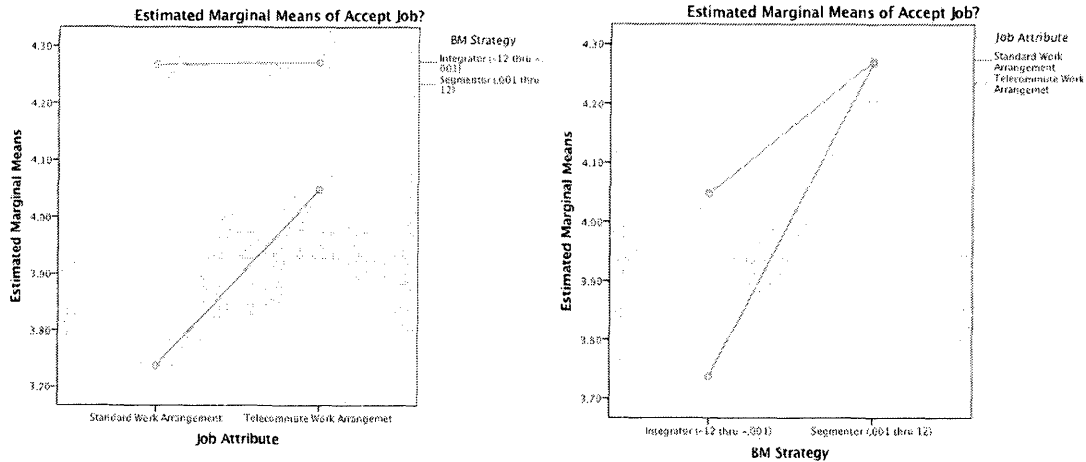


Figure 4. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute.

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management strategy was conducted. The results of this analysis indicated that there was no statistically significant main effect of job attribute, $F(1, 140) = 1.02, p = .31$, partial $\eta^2 = .01$. However, there was a statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy, $F(1, 140) = 5.90, p = .02$, partial $\eta^2 = .04$ (see Table 9). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $3.892 \pm .132$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $4.269 \pm .082$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .377 (95% CI, .070 to .684), $p = .016$.

Table 9

Test of Between-Subject Effects

Dependent Variable: Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
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Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	2.36	0.05	0.07	small/medium	0.58
Intercept	1	2765.00	0.95	0.00	--	1.00
Job Attribute	1	1.02	0.01	0.31	small	0.17
BM Strategy	1	5.90	0.04	0.02	small/medium	0.68
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	0.98	0.01	0.32	small	0.17
Error	140					
Total	144					
Corrected Total	143					

a. R Squared = .048 (Adjusted R squared = .028)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared: 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the job. However, there is less evidence that job attribute (TelWA/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance.

Two-Way ANOVA with Square-Root Data Transformation

Because the data were non-normal and negatively skewed, a square root transformation was applied, and a two-way ANOVA was again conducted using the transformed dataset. After the square root transformation, normality was again assessed using Shapiro-Wilk's normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p=.004$; segmentors $p=.000$) and the TelWA group (integrators $p=.000$; segmentors $p=.000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p =$

.041. The results of the two-way ANOVA with square root data transformation indicated that the interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1, 140) = 1.264, p = .263$, partial $\eta^2 = .009$ (see Figure 5).

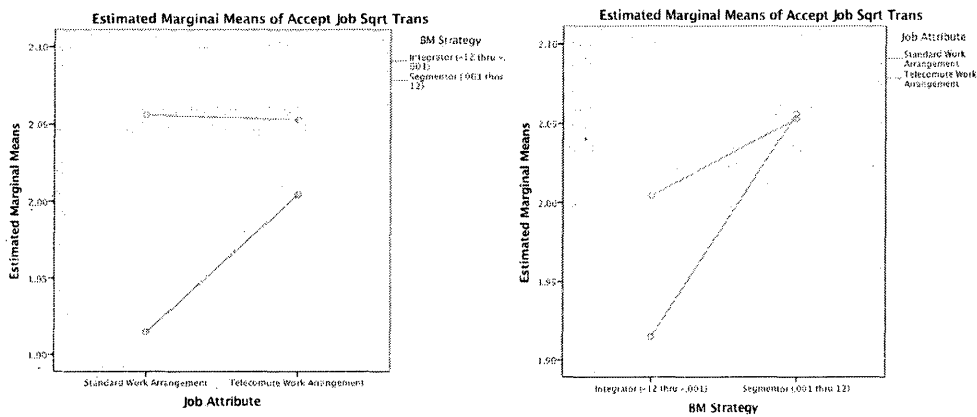


Figure 5. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute with square root transformation.

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management was conducted. The results of this analysis indicated that there was no statistically significant main effect of job attribute, $F(1, 140) = 1.096, p = .297$, partial $\eta^2 = .008$. However, there was a statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy, $F(1, 140) = 5.336, p = .022$, partial $\eta^2 = .037$ (see Table 10). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $1.96 \pm .035$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $2.055 \pm .022$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .095 (95% CI, .014 to .177), $p = .022$.

Table 10

Test of Between-Subject Effects with Square Root Data Transformation

Dependent Variable: Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	2.25	.046	0.09	small/medium	0.56
Intercept	1	9502.578	0.99	0.00	---	1.00
Job Attribute	1	1.10	0.01	0.30	small	0.18
BM Strategy	1	5.34	0.04	0.02	small/medium	0.63
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	1.264	0.01	0.26	small	0.20
Error	140					
Total	144					
Corrected Total	143					

a. R Squared = .046 (Adjusted R squared = .026)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared: 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the job. However, there is less evidence that job attribute (TelWA/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. In other words, applying a square-root transformation to the dataset did not significantly alter the results.

Identification and Treatment of Outliers

Outliers were identified using two methods: (a) inspecting a boxplot and (b) examining studentized residuals. The boxplot inspection revealed 12 outliers, and the studentized residual inspection revealed 7 outliers. First, the data were re-examined to ensure that the outliers were not the result of data entry errors or mathematical errors. Because there was no known method to correct the outliers, the data was analyzed based

on recommendations by DeVeaux, Velleman, and Bock (2012), who suggested that “if we see no way to correct an outlying value, or if we confirm that it is correct, our best path is to report summaries and analyses with and without the outlier” (p. 88).

Outliers identified using the boxplot method included data points which met the criteria cited by DeVeaux et al. (2012): “Any point more than 1.5 IQR from either end of the box in a boxplot is nominated as an outlier” (p. 95). Outliers identified using the studentized method were defined as any studentized residuals that were greater than ± 2.5 (Laerd, 2015, p. 8).

Two-Way ANOVA after Removing Boxplot Outliers (without Square-Root Data Transformation)

After removing the boxplot outliers, normality was assessed using Shapiro-Wilk’s normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p=.007$; segmentors $p=.000$) and the TelWA group (integrators $p=.000$; segmentors $p=.000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene’s test for equality of variances, $p = .000$.

The results of the two-way ANOVA with boxplot outliers removed indicated the interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1, 128) = 0.28$, $p = 0.60$, partial $\eta^2 = .00$ (see Figure 6).

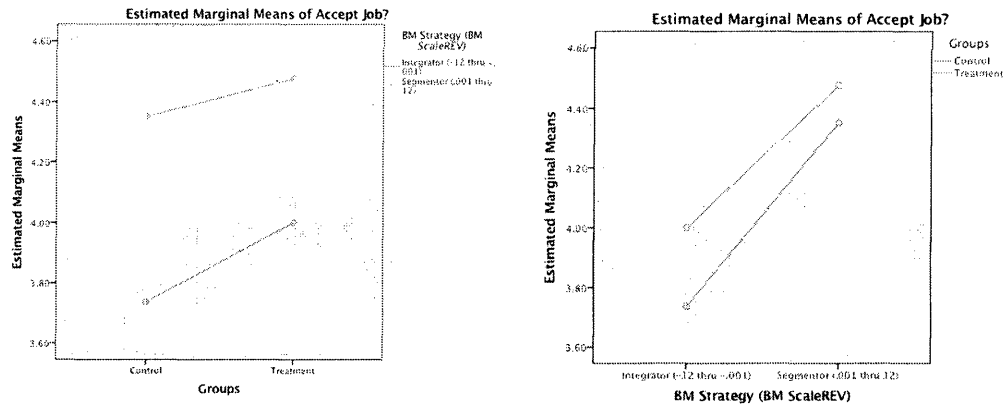


Figure 6. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute with boxplot outliers removed (no transformation).

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management strategy was conducted. The results of this analysis indicated that there was no statistically significant main effect of job attribute, $F(1,128) = 2.19, p = .14$, partial $\eta^2 = .02$. However, there was a statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy, $F(1,128) = 17.30, p = .00$, partial $\eta^2 = .12$ (see Table 11). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $3.868 \pm .113$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $4.415 \pm .067$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .546 (95% CI, .286 to .806), $p = .000$.

Table 11

Test of Between-Subject Effects with Boxplot Outliers Removed (No Transformation)

Dependent Variable: Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	6.79	0.14	0.00	large	.97
Intercept	1	3979.92	0.97	0.00	---	1.00

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Job Attribute	1	2.19	0.02	0.14	small	.3
BM Strategy	1	17.30	0.12	0.00	medium/large	.99
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	0.28	0.00	0.60	small	.08
Error	128					
Total	132					
Corrected Total	131					

a. R Squared = .137 (Adjusted R squared = .117)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared: 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the job. However, there is less evidence that job attribute (TelWA/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. In other words, removing outliers using the boxplot method did not significantly alter the results.

Two-Way ANOVA after Removing Boxplot Outliers (with Square-Root Data Transformation)

After removing the boxplot outliers and applying square-root transformation, normality was again assessed using Shapiro-Wilk's normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p = .004$; segmentors $p = .000$) and the telecommuting group (integrators $p = .000$; segmentors $p = .000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p = .000$.

The results of the two-way ANOVA with boxplot outliers removed and square root transformation applied indicated that the interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1,128) = .653, p = .421$, partial $\eta^2 = .005$ (See Figure 7).

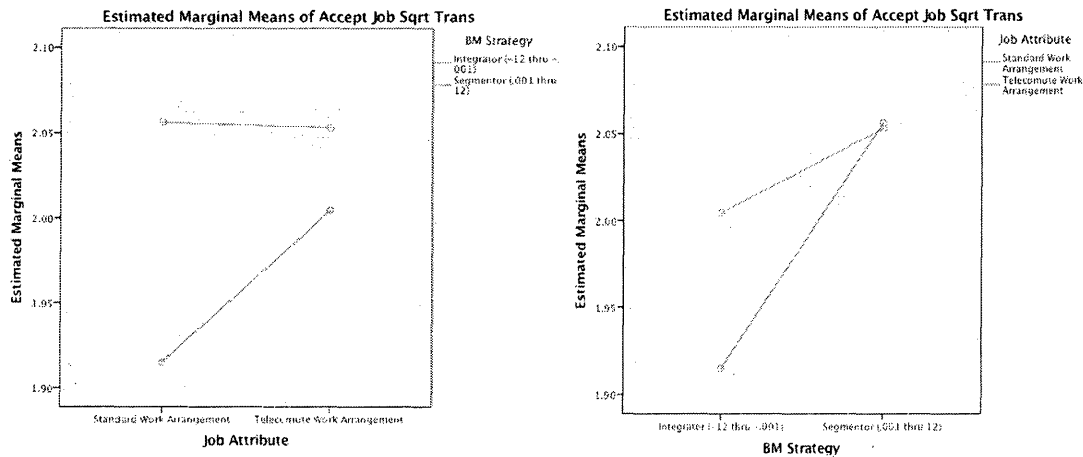


Figure 7. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute with square-root transformation and boxplot outliers removed.

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management strategy was conducted. The results of this analysis indicated that there was no statistically significant main effect of job attribute, $F(1, 128) = 3.024, p = .084$, partial $\eta^2 = .023$. However, there was a statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy, $F(1, 128) = 17.108, p = .000$, partial $\eta^2 = .0118$ (see Table 12). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $1.957 \pm .029$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $2.096 \pm .017$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .138 (95% CI, .76 to .204), $p = .000$.

Table 12

Test of Between-Subject Effects with Square Root Data Transformation and Boxplot

Outliers Removed

Dependent Variable: Sqrt Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	7.08	0.14	0.00	large	0.98
Intercept	1	14711.832	0.99	0.00	---	1.00
Job Attribute	1	3.02	0.02	0.08	medium	0.41
BM Strategy	1	17.11	0.12	0.00	medium/large	0.98
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	0.65	0.01	0.42	small	0.13
Error	128					
Total	132					
Corrected Total	131					

a. R Squared = .142 (Adjusted R squared = .122)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared, 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. However, there is less evidence that Job Attribute (TelWA/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the job. In other words, removing outliers using the boxplot method and applying-square root data transformation did not significantly alter the results.

Two-Way ANOVA after Removing Studentized Residual Outliers (without Square-Root Data Transformation)

After removing the studentized residual outliers, normality was assessed using Shapiro-Wilk's normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p = .007$; segmentors $p = .000$) and the TelWA group (integrators $p = .000$; segmentors $p = .000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p = .001$.

The results of the two-way ANOVA with studentized residual outliers removed indicated that the interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1, 133) = 1.29, p = 0.26$, partial $\eta^2 = 0.01$ (See Figure 8).

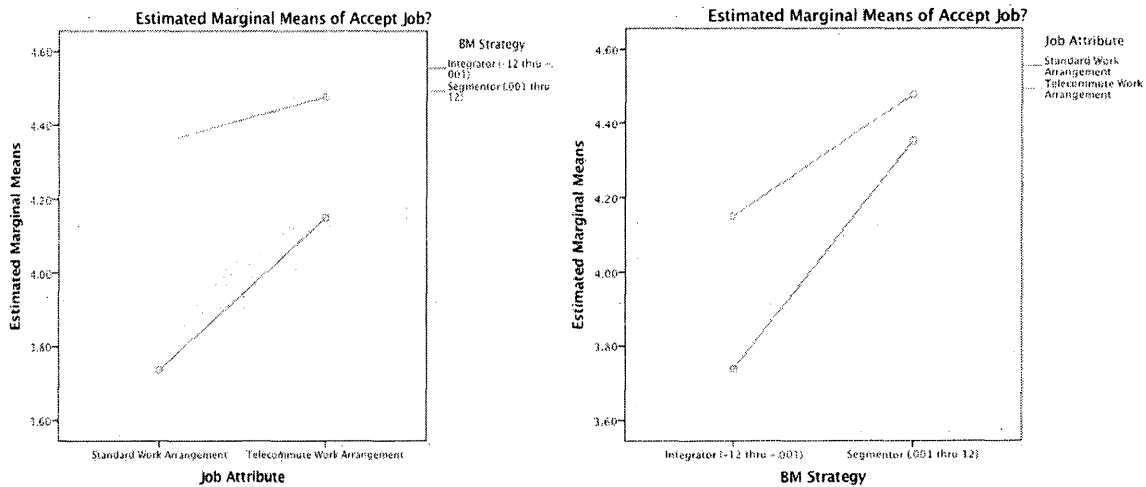


Figure 8. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute with studentized residual outliers removed (no transformation).

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management strategy was conducted and indicated that there was no statistically significant main effect of job attribute, $F(1, 133) = 4.505, p = .036$, partial $\eta^2 = .033$.

However, there was a statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy, $F(1, 133) = 13.79, p = .00$, partial $\eta^2 = .09$ (see Table 13). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $3.943 \pm .107$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $4.415 \pm .068$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .471 (95% CI, .220 to .722), $p = .000$.

Table 13

Test of Between-Subject Effects with Studentized Outliers Removed

Dependent Variable: Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Squared	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	5.90	0.12	0.01	small	0.95
Intercept	1	4339.24	0.98	0.00	--	1.00
Job Attribute	1	4.505	0.03	0.36	small	0.56
BM Strategy	1	13.79	0.09	0.00	medium	0.96
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	1.29	0.01	0.26	small	0.20
Error	133					
Total	137					
Corrected Total	136					

a. R squared = .118 (Adjusted R squared = .098)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared: 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the

job. However, there is less evidence that Job Attribute (TelWA/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. In other words, removing outliers using the studentized method did not significantly alter the results.

Two-Way ANOVA with Square-Root Data Transformation after Removing Studentized Residual Outliers

After removing the studentized outliers and applying square root transformation, normality was assessed using Shapiro-Wilk's normality test for the StdWA group (integrators, $p=.004$; segmentors $p=.000$) and the telecommuting group (integrators $p=.000$; segmentors $p=.000$), which revealed that the data were not normally distributed. The assumption of homogeneity of variances was tested using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p = .000$.

The results of the two way ANOVA with square root data transformation after removing studentized residual outliers indicated that the interaction effect between telecommuting and boundary management strategy on job attraction was not statistically significant, $F(1,133) = 1.859$, $p = .175$, partial $\eta^2 = .014$ (See Figure 9).

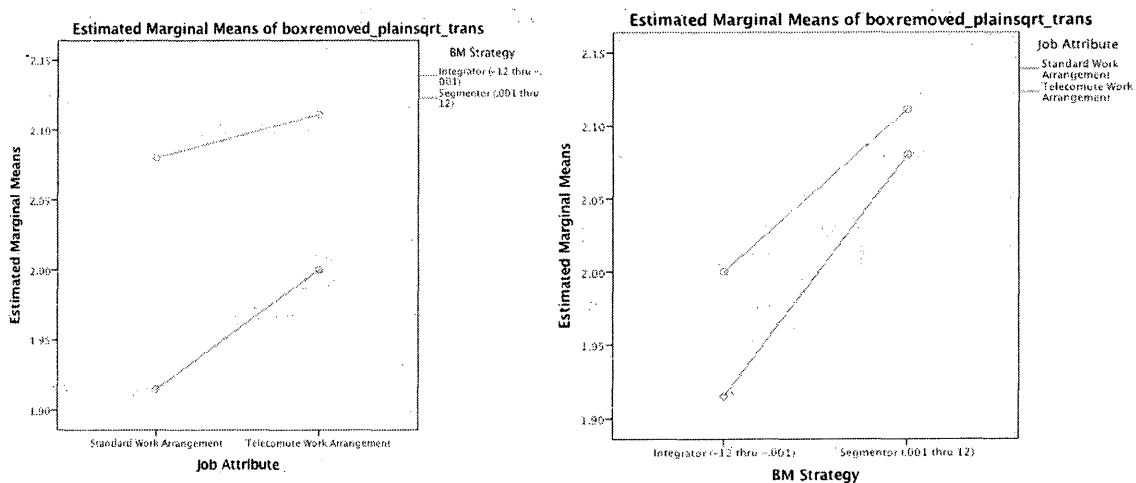


Figure 9. Profile plot indicating the estimated marginal means of boundary management strategy and Job Attribute with square-root data transformation and studentized residual outliers removed.

Therefore, an analysis of the main effect for job attribute and boundary management strategy was conducted and indicated that there was a statistically significant main effect for both variables. The statistically significant main effect of job attribute was $F(1, 133) = 5.428, p = .021$, partial $\eta^2 = .039$. The statistically significant main effect of boundary management strategy was $F(1, 133) = 14.196, p = .000$, partial $\eta^2 = .096$ (see Table 14). The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $1.998 \pm .023$ for standard work arrangement and $2.073 \pm .023$ for telecommuting work arrangement, a statistically significant mean difference of .075 (95% CI, .011 to .139), $p = .000$. The unweighted estimated marginal means for job attraction scores were $1.974 \pm .027$ for integrator boundary management strategy and $2.096 \pm .017$ for segmentor boundary management strategy, a statistically significant mean difference of .121 (95% CI, .058 to .185), $p = .000$.

Table 14

Test of Between-Subject Effects Square-Root Transformation and Studentized Outliers Removed

Dependent Variable: Sqrt Accept job?

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Square	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Corrected Model	3	6.37	0.13	0.00	large	0.96
Intercept	1	15980.064	0.99	0.00	---	1.00

Source	df	F	Partial Eta Square d	Sig.	Effect Size	Observed Power
Job Attribute	1	5.43	0.04	0.02	small	0.64
BM Strategy	1	14.20	0.10	0.00	medium/large	0.96
Job Attribute*BMStrategy	1	1.86	0.01	0.18	small	0.27
Error	133					
Total	137					
Corrected Total	136					

a. R Squared = .126 (Adjusted R squared = .106)

b. Effect sizes using partial eta squared: 0.01 = small, 0.06 = medium, 0.14 = large

These results suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was a feature of the job. There is also evidence that job attribute influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, the group that was offered the TelWA was more likely to accept the job than the group that was offered the StdWA. Removing the studentized residual outliers and transforming the data changed the results slightly, with increased observed power = .96, indicating a statistically significant main effect of job attribute. However, these changes also created increased heterogeneity of variances using Levene's test for equality of variances, $p = .000$.

Despite applying a square-root transformation, removing outliers using the boxplot method, and removing outliers using the studentized residuals method, the variances remained heterogeneous, and data remained non-normal. However, comparing the ratios of variances provided justification for maintaining at least some confidence in

the results/output (see Table 15). According to Jaccard (1998), “If group sample sizes are equal or approximately equal and large, there is normality and the ratio of the largest group variance to the smallest group variance is less than 3, run the two-way ANOVA anyway because it is somewhat robust to heterogeneity of variance in these circumstances” (as cited in Laerd, p. 10).

Table 15

Ratios of Variances between Integrators and Segmentors both in the StdWA and TelWA Groups

Groups		Variance	Ratio	N
StdWA	Integrator	.982	0.61	19
	Segmentor	.600		56
TelWA	Integrator	.447	1.25	21
	Segmentor	.357		48

a. Ratio < 3

Table 16

Ratios of Variances between the StdWA and TelWA Groups

Group	Variance	Ratio	N
StdWA	.739	1.06	75
TelWA	.694		69

a. Ratio < 3

Additionally, Weiss (2006) has reported that simulations have shown ANOVA to be

robust or virtually unaffected by even severe non-normality or gross non-homogeneity when the group sizes are moderately large (p. 123).

Summary

The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a TelWA or a StdWA, depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. After exploratory analyses were conducted, a square root transformation was applied, and outliers were removed using two different methods (i.e., boxplot and studentized residuals) the results remained consistent with the exception of a change to the main effect of job attribute in the square root transformation of data with studentized residual outliers removed. The researcher decided that although this exception would lend support to prior research, the overwhelming evidence led to the following conclusion: ultimately, based on the results of this study, the researcher failed to reject the null hypothesis, which stated the following:

H_0 Boundary management strategies have no effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction.

Prior research studies in the literature indicated that a TelWA job attribute has a positive effect on job attraction (Thompson et al., 2015; Rau & Hyland, 2002); however, the results of this study did not indicate that a TelWA job attribute influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. The results of this study did not support this study's conceptual model, which predicted that boundary management strategy would have a moderating effect on the relationship between telecommuting (TelWA) and job

attraction. This was indicated by the non-statistically significant interaction effect between job attribute and boundary management strategy.

However, the results of this study did suggest that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy as a main effect had a significant effect on the likelihood of accepting the job. The results indicated that segmentors were more likely to accept the job than integrators, regardless of the type of work arrangement (e.g., TelWA or StdWA). Integrators, were more likely to accept the TelWA than the StdWA, but the results were not statistically significant.

The results did not support Hypothesis 1, which stated the following:

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer telecommuting(TelWA) than to those that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA).

The results did not support Hypothesis 2, which stated the following:

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement (StdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting(TelWA).

Chapter 5: Discussion

Research studies have suggested that the effectiveness of flexible work arrangement programs is not unequivocal. In other words, individual differences among employees, including boundary management strategies (i.e., the extent to which individuals enact high integration and high segmentation of their work and family roles), represent an area of concern that has been in need of research (Sutton & Noe, 2005, p. 163). The purpose of this research study was to determine whether there was a statistically significant difference in applicant attraction to a job that offers a telecommuting work arrangement (TelWA) or a standard work arrangement (StdWA), depending on whether participants prefer an integration or segmentation boundary management strategy. In order to accomplish this purpose, the following research question and hypotheses guided this study:

RQ: Do job applicants' boundary management strategies affect the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction?

H₀ Boundary management strategies have no effect on the relationship between telecommuting and job attraction.

H₁ Integrators, due to their preference for more boundaryless work in both time and space, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer telecommuting(TelWA) than to those that offer a standard work arrangement(StdWA).

H₂ Segmentors, due to their preference for strong boundaries between work and personal domains, will have a greater attraction to organizations that offer a standard work arrangement(STdWA) than to those that offer telecommuting(TelWA).

Research Design and Summary of the Method

This cross-sectional study employed a 2 x 2 factorial, between-subjects, quasi-experimental design. The instrument of data collection consisted of three parts. Part 1 consisted of two different versions of a multi-attribute job description for a fictitious firm, similar to job descriptions found on websites of companies planning to hire new employees. Part 2 consisted of a self-report questionnaire containing 12 items that measured boundary management strategies. Part 3 consisted of an additional 12 items designed to collect demographic information.

The study sample included 144 part-time MBA students enrolled in U.S. colleges and universities. Data were collected using Qualtrics, LLC, a private research software company, based in Provo, Utah. Participants who met the inclusion criteria were recruited through an online survey panel identified by Qualtrics. A two-way ANOVA was conducted to determine whether there was a significant difference in applicant attraction to a telecommuting job based on participants' boundary management strategy (i.e., integration or segmentation).

Summary of the Results

After (a) exploratory analyses were conducted, (b) a square root transformation was applied, and (c) outliers were removed using two different methods (i.e., boxplot and studentized residuals), the results indicated that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy (segmentors/integrators) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. However, the results also suggested that there is less evidence that job attribute (i.e. TelWA)/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmenters were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether

telecommuting was an attribute of the job. Based on the results of the data analysis, the researcher failed to reject the null hypothesis.

Discussion

Societal shifts during the last half century have reshaped the borders of work and non-work relationships (Kossek & Distelberg, 2009). Boundary management strategies and their influence on the likelihood of accepting a job represent an important area of research with a broad range of applications. Based on the results of this study, as well as results from prior studies, several interesting points of discussion result.

Unexpected Attraction

Because segmentors erect distinct boundaries between work and life roles, and keep roles cognitively, behaviorally, and physically separate (Kreiner, 2006), it was hypothesized that segmentors would respond more favorably to recruiting efforts that offer a standard 40-hour work arrangement (StdWA) than they would to recruiting efforts that offer a telecommuting work arrangement (TelWA). However, segmentors did not display a preference for the StdWA or the TelWA and were equally as willing to accept the job, regardless of the structure of the work arrangement. This unexpected attraction of segmentors to the TelWA remains rather puzzling, as prior research has indicated that segmentors prefer a distinct definition of the work environment.

One possible explanation for the unexpected attraction of segmentors to the TelWA is that previous telecommuting experience provided a positive experience and altered segmentors' perceptions of the work-from-home option. Half of the participants in the study sample reported that, based on the following definition, they had previous telecommuting experience:

Telecommuting involves employees working a portion of their normal workday hours (ranging from a few hours per week to nearly full time) from home or another remote location, away from a central workplace, using technology to interact with others as needed to conduct work tasks.

It may be that segmentors, based on their previous telecommuting experience, have learned how to construct work/life boundaries in remote locations the same way that they have learned to erect boundaries in a StdWA. Segmentors establish and maintain boundaries in the StdWA through strategies that include (a) refraining from engaging in discussions about family while at work, (b) creating separate work/personal calendars (Nippert-Eng, 1996b), (c) creating separate email accounts for personal and business use, and (d) establishing reliable contingency plans to care for sick children while at work (Kossek & Lautsch, 2008). It is possible that segmentors have applied these same strategies and have created additional strategies in the TelWA, allowing defined and segmented roles, space, and time. A home office that is dedicated exclusively for work during strict and specified “work times” and used by no other family members is an example of a segmentation strategy that may prevent the intermingling of family issues and work issues in the TelWA. Segmentors who are experienced telecommuters, successful at delineating the boundaries in both StdWA and TelWA environments, might be inclined to accept the job, regardless of the structure of the work arrangement, if other attributes of the job are attractive.

A second possible explanation for the unexpected attraction of segmentors to the TelWA is that employers who offer telecommuting have improved their ability to (a) define expectations and limitations of the TelWA and (b) provide guidance and

organizational support. The increasing numbers of companies that offer work-from-home and flexible work arrangements may be the result of improved employer practices. As reported in a 2016 Society for Human Resource Management (SHRM) benefits survey, 60% of companies offer their employees telecommuting opportunities--a threefold increase from 1996 (Gallup, 2016, p. 149). Concepts such as “work-family policies” and “employer work-life supports” increasingly have become a part of everyday discourse within organizations in a variety of industries and professional fields (Kossek & Friede, 2006; Lewis et al., 2007).

As the numbers of organizations offering flexible work arrangements (FWA) have increased, evidence-based recommendations for best practices to implement telecommuting work arrangements also have become increasingly available to employers. Examples of best practices include (a) frequent, clear, communication regarding the structure that supports telecommuting (Perlson & Sanders, 2001); (b) clarity in “hours on”; (c) explicitness in performance criteria; and (d) clear definitions of norms and expectations (Nicklin et al., 2016). Well-designed telecommuting policies and formal telecommuting agreements that have been prepared and signed by all parties--e.g., employees, managers, and human resources departments, have become increasingly more frequent. With the advantage of guidance from professional human resource organizations and employer legal counsel, human resource professionals also have more access to literature, websites, webinars, and conferences supporting the implementation of TelWA.

Subsequently, in addition to more defined policies and practices, employers may be offering additional guidance, training, and support about how to manage the

home/work environment for employees who participate in a TelWA. Training and mentoring about best practices may help employees define job requirements more specifically so that home-based segmentors are able to build boundaries and delineate the structure of their work according to the clear parameters specified by their employers. These boundaries and this defined structure, recommended by employers and established by employees in remote locations, may reduce the potential for role blurring. When roles are highly segmented, there is less permeability between role boundaries, and creating and maintaining these boundaries tends to be easier, thus minimizing role blurring and its associated costs (Rau & Hyland, 2002). Ruderman and Kossek (2012) reported that telework can be expected to blur the boundaries in locations where work is completed. However, the recent improved employer practices, including (a) defining, structuring, and communicating expectations as well as (b) training on how to manage work in remote locations may help segmentors to minimize the blurring of home roles and work roles. Because segmentors tend to prefer definition and parameters that delineate the work and home domains, this could possibly explain why the segmentors in this study were equally attracted to the StdWA as well as the TelWA.

Recommendations for Practice

Based on the results of this study, three recommendations for practice can be offered. The first recommendation for practice is that policy decision makers should give consideration to whether telecommuting should be offered in positions where it makes sense to do so. It has been established that the changing demographics and social norms of the workforce have resulted in powerful attitudinal shifts that will require companies to make job offers that provide a comprehensive set of flexible work arrangements

(FWA)--i.e., TelWA, in order to attract top talent (Bhalla, Drychs, & Strack, 2017). It also has been suggested, based on the results of this study, that improved and defined HR policies and support for those who telecommute encourage job attraction of both integrators and segmentors. In order to further refine and define telecommuting jobs and properly and systematically implement flexible workplaces, positions should be analyzed for suitability to the TelWA. Job analysis should be conducted on key positions within organizations to determine which jobs qualify for TelWA, StdWA, or a combination. At the same time job descriptions are updated and essential functions are reviewed and updated, HR professionals should analyze whether specific jobs are appropriate for telecommuting and determine an appropriate ratio of in-office days to work-from-home days. Each position should be designated as “TelWA,” “StdWA,” or a combination of both, and the acceptable percentage of each that would be acceptable should be identified. Research on best practices has suggested that assigned TelWA/StdWA designations should be re-evaluated annually along with job descriptions as well as the time at which these positions are offered for employment. By systematically and routinely defining whether positions qualify for TelWA and at what percentage, policy makers will be able to further define and enhance the TelWA option.

The second recommendation for practice is that hiring managers should understand the characteristics of boundary management strategy as an individual difference and integrate pre-employment testing for BMS into hiring and promotion procedures. By implementing this recommendation and incorporating boundary management strategy as a component of the job placement equation, employers would

have the potential to improve the job/person fit for employees as well as potential employees.

Because work/life balance continues to be an important issue for employees who are attempting to balance work responsibilities with home responsibilities as well as employers who are attempting to attract and retain top talent, it is important to understand individual differences at play within different types of work arrangements. Testing for boundary management strategy types could provide useful information about this individual difference from the perspective of the employee and the organization's hiring professionals and policy makers. Rothbard et al. (2005) reported that the fit between (a) an individual's desire for segmentation or integration and (b) available organizational policies and offerings of FWA influenced job attitudes.

The results of the current study indicated that boundary management strategy influenced job attraction. As future research continues to refine understanding about boundary management strategies and job attraction, organizations will benefit from (a) defining the jobs within the organization that lend themselves to FWA and (b) defining applicants' boundary management strategy (i.e., segmentor/integrator) to match the requirements of the position. If trained HR professionals are able to employ pre-employment testing using a validated instrument to measure preferred boundary management strategies, all potential employees and current employees being considered for job placement would benefit. Human resource professionals could discuss the results of the BMS indicator with potential employees and, with input from employees, agree on how their results fit with the TelWA/StdWA requirement of the job. For example, if the job requirement were to work remote three days during the week and work in the office

two days, this could be discussed with the “segmentor” or “integrator” as well as how the arrangement fits with their particular BMS. Such considerations will aid both parties in the job placement decision and the long-term job/person fit.

The third recommendation for practice is that organizational leaders and HR professionals consider their organizational culture as it relates to FWA and job attraction. The perception that job applicants and current employees hold about organizational culture might influence their decisions to accept a position. Cantanzaro, Moore, and Marshall (2010) reported that organizational culture influences applicant attraction and participants reported that organizational culture influences applicant attraction and participants reported stronger interest in working for a supportive organization, even though salary would be lower. The results of the current study on job attraction indicated that a large majority (84%) of participants reported that they would be somewhat or very likely to accept the job. Participants ostensibly made that decision based on the job and the organization as presented in the job description. In the job description, the management consulting firm’s culture was portrayed as extremely supportive of employee well-being and flexibility.

However, several work and family researchers have asserted that despite increased formal adoption of FWA policies, organizational adaptation to changing work and family demands have not been integrated completely into organizational cultures (Ruderman & Kossek, 2012). Moreover, many employers have encountered difficulty implementing FWA cultural initiatives sufficiently to reap the benefits of reduced worker stress, increased retention and recruitment, and fuller utilization of human resources (Ryan & Kossek, 2008). Despite the growing societal pressures in support of

mainstreaming a flexible work culture, it is increasingly apparent that the development and even the implementation of work-life policies does not necessarily result in organizational integration. Thompson et al. (1999) explained that one measure of work/family organizational culture includes supervisor support, and Allen (2001) emphasized that informal supervisor support for work and family may be more important than the provision of formal workplace policies. Organizational leaders and HR professionals who wish to offer FWA policies will need to be intentional about creating (a) not only a structure that supports such policies but also (b) frequent, clear, communication regarding the values and vision of embedding work/life flexibility support into the culture.

Recommendations for Future Research

In the same way that the work of prior researchers has informed this investigation, the results of this study provide a pathway for future researchers. Based on the results of this study, seven recommendations for future research can be offered. These recommendations can be separated into two areas: methodological and topical.

Methodological Recommendations

The first methodological recommendation for future research is to limit the sample to participants holding non-managerial positions. Forty-two percent of the sample in this study was comprised of executive/senior officers, senior managers, and first/mid-level managers. However, employees holding executive and managerial positions likely would not be interested in a position requiring telecommuting three or more days per week, nor is it likely that board members of larger organizations would endorse such a telecommuting arrangement at higher executive levels. The responsibilities of managerial

positions typically require on-site presence. In addition, executives and senior officers' responsibilities may require travel. Managers and executives at these positions would not typically be expected to work from home three or more days per week. As a result, the sizeable presence of managerial and executive participants in the sample may have influenced the results. In order to avoid such a limitation in future studies, it is recommended that future researchers seek a greater representation of non-managerial employees in the sample frame.

The second methodological recommendation for future research is to consider increased emphasis on the active variable: job attribute (e.g., TelWA, StdWA) when presenting the job description to participants. In response to the questionnaire item that measured job attraction, 84% of participants responded positively, indicating they would be *very likely* or *somewhat likely* to accept the job, regardless of whether the job offered a TelWA or StdWA. It is possible that the TelWA job attribute was not salient because, in fact, several sections of the job description emphasized work-life balance and developmental opportunities for employees.

Recent research has indicated that top talent is attracted to opportunities for well-being, individual development, and individualized environments (Bhalla, Drychs, & Strack, 2017; Gallup, 2017). Therefore, the job may have been attractive to participants, regardless of the TelWA job attribute. An overtone in the job description suggesting a culture that includes work-life balance and an emphasis on individual development may have influenced the responses more than the single statement indicating the presence or absence of telecommuting. Several of the statements included in both the StdWA and

TelWA job descriptions may have implied flexible work arrangements. Examples of these statements include the following:

(a) Our positive and supportive culture celebrates individuals by recognizing their uniqueness and offering them the flexibility to make daily choices that can help them to be healthy, centered, confident and aware. (b) We offer well-being programs and are continuously looking for new ways to maintain a culture where our people excel and lead healthy, happy lives. (c) ABC offers an award-winning culture that supports our employees' development of their personal brand through learning opportunities, professional experiences, inclusion, collaboration, and personal well-being. (d) At ABC, our professional development plan focuses on helping employees at every level of their career to identify and use their strengths to do their best work every day. From entry-level employees to senior leaders, we offer opportunities to sharpen skills. On-the-job learning experiences and formal development programs give our professionals a variety of opportunities to grow throughout their career.

Future researchers using an experimental design would benefit from stimuli that assure salience of the focal variable.

The third methodological recommendation for future research is also related to the treatment stimulus (i.e., the job description) and reducing its length. The researcher designed the job description, used as the primary stimulus, by revising a recruitment brochure, developed and used by Rau and Hyland (2002), to resemble online recruitment advertisements by several current national and international management consulting firms posted on INDEED.com. The verbiage used in the recruiting job descriptions of

these well-known and respected management consulting firms, as well as the layout and length, provided guidelines for the job descriptions used in this study. However, because this was an artificial situation in which participants were not pursuing an authentic job opportunity, participants may not have taken the time to read the entire job description closely. This was evident from the number of participants in the control group who responded “yes” to the manipulation item, which asked whether telecommuting was a job attribute in the job description they received. Numerous participant cases were removed because participants responded to this item incorrectly. In a future study in which it is necessary to simulate a job description, a shorter job description might encourage more attention to the contents and the important variables being manipulated.

The fourth methodological recommendation for future research is to consider presenting the job description in a face-to-face setting. The online Qualtrics panel was convenient and allowed timely access to the participants who met the sample criteria. However, it is possible that the incentivized panel participants who received the questionnaire from a somewhat impersonal online source, did not experience a vested interest in the outcome. It is also possible that although measures were taken to encourage commitment of the participants (i.e., a screening question in the survey--“I commit to thoughtfully providing my best answers to each question in the survey”--and a timer on the job description page to prevent going forward until sufficient time to read the job description passed), these measures were insufficient to motivate thoughtful and serious reflection about the items presented. A physical setting in which the directions are provided verbally, as well as in writing, may create an environment in which the participants spend more time reading the items presented and more carefully consider

their responses. The physical presence and personal connection of a researcher might provide more impetus for careful thought to the participants' responses. According to Lavaskas (2008), the personal interview has continued to be the best form of data collection to maximize the quality of the data collected.

Topical Recommendations

In addition to methodological recommendations for future research, three topical recommendations for future research can be made. The first topical recommendation for future research involves the study of previous telecommuting experience and whether this prior experience influences attraction to telecommuting jobs. Approximately half of the participants in this study reported previous telecommuting experience. The concentration of prior telecommuting experience in the sample raises the question of whether prior telecommuting experience was a factor in the choices that the participants made about accepting the job with the TelWA/StdWA. Limited research has been conducted on job attraction and prior telecommuting experience; however, one recent study was conducted in C-Trip, a large Chinese, NASDAQ-listed firm of 16,000 employees. The C-Trip study was the first randomized experiment that focused on working from home. The research study primarily explored productivity; however, when the experiment ended and workers were provided the option to continue working from home or to work at the office, more than half of the treatment group chose to return to the office (Bloom, Liang, Roberts, & Ying, 2015). Conversely, in this current study, with half of the participants having previous telecommuting experience, the largest group of participants (i.e., segmentors) showed no preference for the TelWA or the StdWA, choosing each option equally. The seemingly contradictory results of this study and the C-Trip study suggests that additional

research into the influence of previous telecommuting experience on the acceptance of jobs that offer telecommuting would be beneficial. Additionally, research on the process that employees use to learn about their own suitability for telecommuting through prior experience and whether boundary management strategy is a factor in this process would contribute to the literature on individual differences, FWA, and job attraction.

The second topical recommendation for future research involves the study of the generational effect on telecommuting, boundary management strategy, and job attraction. For example, future studies might investigate whether specific generations are more or less attracted to jobs that offer telecommuting and whether boundary management strategy moderates job attraction within generational groups. The median age of the sample in this study was 37. Nearly half (49%) of the sample consisted of members of the millennial generation (age 20 to 36 years). More than one in three American workers today are millennials, who have become the largest faction of the American workforce (Pew, 2015). Research has indicated that to serve the needs of millennials, HR practices should offer some flexibility in terms of the number of hours worked, the schedule of when those hours are worked, and the location of the work (Kultalahti & Viitala, 2015). Recent surveys (Gallup, 2017) also have indicated that millennials and older workers are attracted to jobs offering work-from-home opportunities. A future study, stratifying the sample by generational age, identifying boundary management strategy, and measuring attraction to telecommuting work arrangements would provide valuable information for organizations and hiring managers attempting to attract and retain millennial talent.

A third topical recommendation for future research is to conduct similar research across industries. This current study focused on individuals seeking employment in the

field of business. Although this field and the participants in this study encompassed a wide variety of specialties, including management, accounting, finance, human resources, IT, marketing, and operations, it is possible that there are similarities in individuals working in business that vary from individuals working in other disciplines. Desires and needs for FWA, as well as different boundary management strategies that affect job attraction, may be diverse across industries.

Organizational norms, priorities, and expectations within an industry may influence employees' boundary management strategies. For example, employees in the healthcare industry working in nonprofit hospitals might be influenced by the norms of a culture that leans toward flexibility. For example, nurses are able to work three 12-hour shifts because the organizational emphasis may be on individual employee health and well-being. Healthcare employees may feel more freedom to enact their preferred boundary management strategies and choose a job with flextime or flexplace because of an organizational culture that supports choices for individual well-being. Likewise, a non-profit human service industry may have a culture that supports individual differences and prioritizes work/life balance differently from other industries where workplace norms are still based on the concept of "ideal workers who always place work ahead of family" (Kanter, 1977). Conducting a study similar to this one across industries would further contribute to the work/life literature through an understanding of individual differences of employees within industries and how differences in organizational cultures contribute to individual boundary management strategies. and job attraction.

Summary

Attracting top talent is a continuing challenge for employers in a landscape of rapidly evolving information communication technologies and changing social norms in the workforce. The diverse and changing demographics of the U.S. workforce has created a demand for flexible work arrangements. Telecommuting, the most popular flexible work arrangement, has become an effective organizational strategy to attract and retain top talent as well as a means for those in the workforce to manage multiple work/life roles. However, although telecommuting is a popular employee benefit offered to employees, it is not a panacea; the manner in which individuals manage and experience boundaries between the work domain and personal domain may be important in attracting applicants to jobs that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement.

The purpose of this study was to understand why some job applicants are attracted to job opportunities that offer telecommuting as a flexible work arrangement and others are not attracted. Boundary theory, an emerging body of work in the work/life research field, provided a theoretical framework for understanding how people manage multiple roles by focusing on the boundary between their work roles and non-work roles (Ashforth et al., 2000; Nippert-Eng, 1996; Perlow, 1998; Kossek et al., 1999). This study attempted to answer the question of whether job applicants' boundary management strategy (i.e., integration or segmentation of the work domain and personal domain) affected their attraction to a job offering a telecommuting work arrangement.

In order to answer this question, data were collected through a Qualtrics, LLC, online survey panel from 144 part-time MBA students across the U.S. who were interested in pursuing professional job opportunities in business. Using a between-subject

design, participants were presented a fictitious job description similar to job descriptions of well-known management services consulting firms. After indicating their attraction to the job, participants completed a questionnaire that identified their boundary management strategy. A two-way ANOVA was conducted to analyze the data.

The results suggested that there is some evidence that boundary management strategy influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. However, the results also suggested that there is less evidence that job attribute (i.e., TelWA)/StdWA) influenced the likelihood of job acceptance. More specifically, segmentors were more likely to accept the job, regardless of whether telecommuting was an attribute of the job.

A discussion of the unexpected attraction of segmentors to the telecommuting work arrangement and several possibilities that explain these counterintuitive results were offered, including (a) previous telecommuting experience and (b) improved employer guidance and organizational support. Recommendations for practice included (a) pre-employment testing for boundary management strategies and (b) integrating BMS through structural (e.g., job analysis and design, human resource policies) and cultural (e.g., supportive supervisors, climate factors). In addition to several methodological recommendations, future researchers were advised to study (a) generational differences in BMS and job attraction and (b) differences in BMS, telecommuting, and job attraction across industries. Ultimately, this study contributes to the work/life literature and the construct of boundary management strategy as well as to practitioners interested in considering individual differences as they relate to the telecommuting benefit and job attraction.

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Appendix A

Boundary Management Strategy Scale

Kossek, Lautsch, & Eaton (2006)

With the increasing demands of work and home, employees may work in different ways to handle these demands. Indicate your agreement with the following nine items using the scale ranging from 1 = strongly agree to 5 = strongly disagree.

1= strongly agree 2= agree 3= neither agree or disagree 4= disagree 5= strongly disagree

1. _____ I only take care of personal needs at work when I am “on break” or during my lunch hour.
2. _____ I prefer not to talk about my family issues with most people I work with.
3. _____ Throughout the day, I deal with personal and work issues as they occur.
4. _____ It would be rare for me to read non-work related materials at work.
5. _____ I tend to integrate work and family roles through the work day.
6. _____ I tend to handle emails related to my family separate from emails related to work, so I can focus.
7. _____ I try not to think about my family or friends when at work, so I can focus.
8. _____ I tend not to talk about work issues with my family.
9. _____ I actively strive to keep my family and work-life separate.

Please answer separated or integrated to the following question:

10. All in all, do you currently see yourself as someone who tries to keep work and personal roles separated most of the time, or someone who tries to keep them integrated?

_____ Separated _____ Integrated

We now want to ask you about how your workspace is set up at home.

11. Do you use this space in your home only for work?

_____ Yes _____ No

12. Does your family use this space when you are not there?

_____ Yes _____ No

Appendix B

Pilot Email Invitation

Dear Anderson MBA student,

I am a doctoral candidate at Anderson University in the research phase of my work and must pilot test (face validate) my survey instrument. I am studying work-life boundary management strategy and its relationship to job attraction.

I am sending this email to Anderson MBA students who I believe will offer valuable input on the mechanics and content of the survey instrument. If you are willing to participate, the survey will require 10 - 15 minutes to complete. Below is a link which will take you to the survey. If I do not receive a response, I will send you a reminder email in a week. If you do not wish to participate or receive a reminder email, please click the link at the bottom to "opt out of future emails".

I appreciate any time and feedback that you can provide. The confidentiality of your anonymous participation will be strictly maintained. This research has been approved by the DBA Human Subjects in Research Committee of Anderson University (Indiana).

Thank you for your consideration,

Carla Quickel
Doctoral Candidate, Anderson University
Anderson, IN 46012
Email: cequickel@anderson.edu
[260-481-2285](tel:260-481-2285)

Follow this link to the Survey:

[\\${1://SurveyLink?d=Take the survey}](#)

Or copy and paste the URL below into your internet browser:

[\\${1://SurveyURL}](#)

Follow the link to opt out of future emails:

[\\${1://OptOutLink?d=Click here to unsubscribe}](#)

Appendix C

Reminder Email

Dear \${m://FirstName},

You are receiving this email as a **reminder** that the window to complete the doctoral study survey on work-life boundary management and job attraction will close on Wednesday, May 10. The validity of the results will be strengthened by your participation.

It is estimated that the survey will take 10 - 15 minutes to complete. If you would like to participate, please click on the link below that will take you to the survey. If you have already completed the survey, I apologize for the intrusion and thank you for your assistance in the study.

Again, I appreciate any time and feedback that you can lend. The confidentiality of your anonymous participation will be strictly maintained. This research has been approved by the DBA Human Subjects Committee of Anderson University (Indiana).

Thank you for your participation,

Carla Quickel
Doctoral Candidate Anderson University
Anderson, IN 46012
Email: cequickel@anderson.edu
260-481-2285

Follow this link to the Survey:

[\\${l://SurveyLink?d=Take the survey}](#)

Or copy and paste the URL below into your internet browser:

[\\${l://SurveyURL}](#)

Follow the link to opt out of future emails:

[\\${l://OptOutLink?d=Click here to unsubscribe}](#)

Appendix D

Pilot Email to Friends and Family

Dear \${m://FirstName},

I am in the research phase of my doctoral work and must pilot test (face validate) the survey instrument. Briefly, my DBA is in Management, and I am studying work-life boundary management strategy and its relationship to job attraction.

I have sent this email to MBA students who will offer input on the mechanics and content of the survey. Your input as a pilot tester would also be valuable. The survey will take 10 - 15 minutes to complete. If you are willing to participate, you may access the survey through the link below. I have placed a special comments section (in red print) throughout the survey where you can share feedback about the content and mechanics of the survey, in addition to answering the survey questions.

If I do not receive a response, I will send you a reminder email in a week. If you do not wish to participate or receive a reminder email, please click the link at the bottom to "unsubscribe".

I appreciate any time and feedback that you can provide.

Thank you kindly for your consideration,

Carla Quickel
Doctoral Candidate, Anderson University
Anderson, IN 46012
Email: cequickel@anderson.edu
260-481-2285

Follow this link to the Survey:

[\\${l://SurveyLink?d=Take the survey}](#)

Or copy and paste the URL below into your internet browser:

[\\${l://SurveyURL}](#)

Follow the link to opt out of future emails:

[\\${l://OptOutLink?d=Click here to unsubscribe}](#)

Appendix E

Thank-You Email

Dear Anderson MBA student,

Thank you for participating in my research on work-life boundary management strategy and its relationship to job attraction. I am grateful for your time and feedback. If you would like a report on results when the study is complete, please email me at cequickel@anderson.edu.

I wish you the best in your graduate studies and in your career.

With appreciation,

Carla Quickel
Doctoral Candidate, Anderson University
Anderson, IN 46012
Email: cequickel@anderson.edu
260-481-2285

Follow the link to opt out of future emails:
[Click here to unsubscribe](#)

Appendix F
Online Questionnaire

Job Attraction Survey

Q1.1 Welcome to our survey! You will be asked to complete three sections.

Section 1 asks you to read a recruiting job description followed by a question regarding your attraction to the job.

Section 2 is a short survey of ten questions.

Section 3 includes approximately ten demographic questions.

Thank you for your participation in this study.

Q36 Following is a recruiting job description for a U.S. business. Please read it carefully. After you finish reading, you will be asked a question regarding your attraction to this job.

Management Consultant

ABC Corporation/ U.S. Division

Description

ABC Corporation is a best practice firm and one of the world's leading professional service organizations, helping clients solve complex challenges and critical transformations. ABC applies talent from many areas including **accounting, finance, human resources, IT, marketing, and operations**. Founded in 1940, ABC operates in nearly 100 offices throughout the United States in addition to our overseas division.

Work You'll Do

Our Consultants lend support to some of the world's most admired brands and Fortune 500 companies. The Consultant focuses on clients' existing processes, people, and culture to help them achieve dramatic improvements in productivity, quality, and service, leading to the achievement of the client's strategic objectives. Strategic shifts such as new products and services, market expansion, evolving growth strategies, innovative technology, new leadership, or mergers and acquisitions require the consultant team to assist in the transformation of practices and processes.

Our Consultants use their unique skills, education, and experience in their field to achieve high impact, sustainable business results. Consultants are placed in assignments with ABC Consultant teams, according to their level of experience in the business area they are applying to. Some positions require travel and other positions do not require travel.

All consultant positions require telecommuting from home or another remote location a minimum of three days per week. State of the art technology and equipment needed to support telecommuting will be provided and maintained by ABC company and its talented IT support staff.

The Team

ABC offers an award-winning culture that supports our employees' development of their personal brand through learning opportunities, professional experiences, inclusion, collaboration, and personal well-being.

At ABC, our professional development plan focuses on helping employees at every level of their career to identify and use their strengths to do their best work every day. From entry level employees to senior leaders, we offer opportunities to sharpen skills. On-the-job learning experiences and formal development programs give our professionals a variety of opportunities to grow throughout their career.

Preferred Qualifications

- Bachelor's Degree in Business, Management, IT, or related field
- MBA is a plus (will consider individuals currently pursuing a master's level degree)
- Demonstrated ability to manage projects and facilitate problem-solving among teams
- Ability to balance delivery of results, problem solving, and client management
- Strong oral and written communication skills
- Highly motivated and results driven

Benefits

At ABC we know that great people make a great organization. We value our employees and offer a broad range of benefits including:

- - Medical, dental, and vision insurance, dependents eligible
- - 401(k) retirement plan with company match
- - Employee Stock Purchase Plan
- - Benefits Start Day One
- - Additional attractive benefits

Our positive and supportive culture celebrates individuals by recognizing their uniqueness and offering them the flexibility to make daily choices that can help them to be healthy, centered, confident and aware. We offer well-being programs and are continuously looking for new ways to maintain a culture where our people excel and lead healthy, happy lives.

ABC Corporation provides a fair and equal employment opportunity for all job applicants regardless of race, color, religion, national origin, gender, sexual orientation, age, marital status or disability. ABC Corporation hires and promotes individuals solely based on their qualifications for the job to be filled. We expect

and require the cooperation of all employees in maintaining a discrimination and harassment-free atmosphere.

Please answer the question on the next page....

Q3.2 If you qualified for the job described, and you were trying to decide among several job offers, what is the likelihood that you would accept the job described above?

- ☐ Very likely (1)
- ☐ Somewhat likely (2)
- ☐ Neither likely or unlikely (3)
- ☐ Somewhat unlikely (4)
- ☐ Very unlikely (5)

In the job description, was telecommuting one of the job attributes?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q4.1 With the increasing demands of work and home, employees may work in different ways to handle these demands. Indicate your agreement with the following nine items using the scale ranging from 1 =strongly agree to 5 = strongly disagree.

Q4.2 I only take care of personal needs at work when I am “on break” or during my lunch hour.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.3 I prefer not to talk about my family issues with most people I work with.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.4 Throughout the day, I deal with personal and work issues as they occur.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.5 It would be rare for me to read non-work related materials at work.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree or disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.6 I tend to integrate work and family roles through the work day.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.7 I tend to handle emails related to my family separate from emails related to work, so I can focus.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.8 I try not to think about my family or friends when at work, so I can focus.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.9 I tend not to talk about work issues with my family.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.10 I actively strive to keep my family and work-life separate.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Q4.11 Please answer separated or integrated to the following question: All in all, do you currently see yourself as someone who tries to keep work and personal roles separated most of the time, or someone who tries to keep them integrated?

- ☐ Separated (1)
- ☐ Integrated (2)

Q2.1 What is your age?

- ☐ 21 or under (1)
- ☐ 22 -30 (2)
- ☐ 31 - 40 (3)
- ☐ 41-52 (4)
- ☐ 53-65 (5)
- ☐ 66 or more (6)

Q2.2 What is your gender?

- ☐ Male (1)
- ☐ Female (2)

Q2.3 Please indicate your ethnic background.

- ☐ African American (1)
- ☐ Asian (2)
- ☐ Caucasian (3)
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino (4)
- ☐ Native American (5)
- ☐ Other (please specify) (6) _____

Q2.4 What is your educational attainment (maximum)?

- ☐ Associate degree (1)
- ☐ Bachelor degree (2)
- ☐ Master degree (3)
- ☐ Doctorate degree (4)
- ☐ Other (please specify) (5) _____

Q2.5 Are you now married, widowed, divorced, separated or never married?

- ☐ Married (1)
- ☐ Widowed (3)
- ☐ Divorced or separated (4)
- ☐ Never married (5)

Q2.6 Who, other than you, lives in your home (you may choose more than one)?

- ☐ Spouse (2)
- ☐ Significant other (3)
- ☐ 1 - 2 children under 18 (4)
- ☐ 3 or more children under 18 (5)
- ☐ Children over 18 (6)
- ☐ Other (please specify) (7) _____
- ☐ No one other than me lives in my home (1)

Q2.7 Does your spouse work outside the home?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q2.8 Does your significant other work outside the home?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q2.9 Do you have elder care responsibility?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q2.10 What is your current job status?

- ☐ Employed full-time (1)
- ☐ Employed part-time (2)
- ☐ Not working (disabled) (3)
- ☐ Not working (retired) (4)
- ☐ Not working (other) (5)

Q2.11 Please indicate your occupation:

- ☐ Executive (1)
- ☐ Management (2)
- ☐ Professional (3)
- ☐ Administrative and support (4)
- ☐ Sales (5)
- ☐ Production, transportation, and material moving (6)
- ☐ Construction or maintenance (7)
- ☐ Farming, fishing, and forestry (8)
- ☐ Government (9)
- ☐ Retired (10)
- ☐ Other (please specify) (11) _____

Q28 Have you ever had a job that included telecommuting from home or another remote location?

- ☐ Yes (1)
- ☐ No (2)

Q29 Thank you for your participation in this study.

Appendix G

Human Subjects Committee Approval



April 3, 2017

Carla Quickel
301 Foxberry Lake Run
Fort Wayne, IN 46845

Dear Carla,

Regarding your request for approval to conduct research using human subjects: The DBA Human Subjects Committee has reviewed your proposed questionnaire and your method for gathering information for your dissertation entitled,

"Work-life Boundary Management Strategy and its Relationship to Job Attraction"

After discussing your request and reviewing the current version of your survey instrument, the DBA Human Subjects Committee **approves** your request to continue the conducting of your research.

You will need to continue to respond to editing and methodological requirements of your chair as well as other members of your dissertation committee.

Should the need arise for you to significantly modify your data gathering process then you will need to resubmit a request to the DBA Human Subjects Committee.

We wish you well as you progress towards the completion of your dissertation and your DBA degree.

Sincerely,

Jeffrey M. Buck, Ph. D.
Graduate Business Programs

Appendix H

IRB Approval



Notice of Human Subjects Review Board (HSRB) Action

Exempt Study Title: Work-life Boundary Management Strategy and its Relationship to Job Attraction

Protocol Number: 17004 **Principle Investigator:** Carla Quickel

Date of Correspondence: April 18, 2017

Your exemption request was reviewed by members of the Ivy Tech Community College Institutional Review Board. Your research was determined to be exempt from further HSRB review under **[Category 2] [Research involving the use of educational tests]**.

Please make note of the following:

- This notification should be retained for your records.
- If the exempted protocol changes in a way such that the basis for exemption is no longer accurate, and may no longer conform to the criteria for exemption, a new Initial Review application will need to be submitted. Investigators should contact the HSRB office via email prior to making changes in order to confirm that the exemption status will not be affected.
- Exempting an activity from review does not absolve the investigator(s) from ensuring that the rights and welfare of subjects in the activity is protected and that methods used and information provided to gain subject consent are appropriate to the activity.
- Investigators of exempt research are expected to be guided by the ethical principles for all research involving humans as subjects, set forth in the report of the National Commission for the Protection of Human Subjects of Biomedical and Behavioral Research (the "Belmont Report"). For a copy of the Belmont Report, see <http://www.hhs.gov/ohrp/humansubjects/guidance/belmont.htm>.
- Please note that HSRB approval does not obligate faculty, staff, or students to participate in your study. If you have not done so already, you will need to secure the cooperation of regional leadership by contacting the Vice Chancellor of Academic Affairs of each involved region. Once you have that authorization, you may proceed with the project as described in your research application. Please contact the IRB office at 317-917-5707 or cclasemann@ivytech.edu with any questions.

Thank you,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Cory Clasemann-Ryan'.

Cory Clasemann-Ryan, Ph.D.
Assistant Vice President for Student Success
HSRB Chair

Vita

CARLA E. QUICKEL

**301 Foxberry Lake Run, Fort Wayne, Indiana 46845 · 260.438.3275 ·
carlaquickel@gmail.com**

EDUCATION

Doctor of Business Administration, May 2018

Falls School of Business, Anderson University, Anderson Indiana

Dissertation: Work-Life Boundary Management Strategy and its Relationship to Job Attraction

Master of Business Administration, “with distinction”

Benedictine University, Lisle, Illinois

Bachelor of Arts, Psychology, *magna cum laude*

Millersville University, Millersville, Pennsylvania

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Senior Professional Human Resources (SPHR), December 2006 – present

Certified Professional Human Resources (SHRM-SCP) January 2015 - present

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IVY TECH COMMUNITY COLLEGE of Indiana

Fort Wayne Indiana Campus

Nation’s largest single-accredited, state-wide, community college system serving 160,000 students

Associate Professor – School of Business

(August 2008 – present)

Research, prepare content, and teach Business Administration and Human Resource Management courses.

- **Engage diverse student population to meet course objectives through multiple and continually evolving teaching strategies.**
- **Teach project-based, service-learning class (principles of management) supporting the college food pantry.**

- Established modified learning-community class in three linked classes yielding theme-based learning experiences.
- Mentor business internship students and facilitate business internship course.
- Certified on-line instructor: developed on-line content for Organizational Behavior and Human Resource Management courses.
- Participate in faculty coaching program for at-risk students
- Provide academic advising on career goals, curriculum choices, and scheduling.
- Serve on college hiring committees and statewide business curriculum committee.
- Assisted in the development of performance evaluation metrics for college program chair position.
- Selected as Northeast Region's School of Business nominee for statewide teaching excellence award.

Adjunct Faculty Positions

TRINE UNIVERSITY, Fort Wayne, Indiana campus (2009 to 2011)

- Developed and presented course content for Employment Law and Human Resource Management classes.

INDIANA TECH, Fort Wayne, Indiana

- Taught graduate level Human Resource Management class for MBA Program. (2005 to 2007)

CONCORDIA UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN, Fort Wayne, Indiana Campus

- Taught Compensation Management and Staffing in the Human Resource Management concentration. (2003 to 2007)

DUCHARME, MCMILLEN & ASSOCIATES, INC.

Fort Wayne, Indiana

Human Resource Manager

(February 2008 to August 2008)

Performed Human Resource generalist functions for 250 employee corporate tax accounting firm.

- Developed, communicated, and administered Human Resource policies.
- Administered Corporate Compensation program.
- Assessed needs, developed, and presented training programs to professional and managerial employees.
- Administered employee performance appraisal program.

INDIANA TECH

Fort Wayne, Indiana

Admissions Representative - College of Professional Studies

(January 2004 to February 2008)

- Awarded *Marketing Person of the Year, 2005*
- Developed, nurtured, and maintained relationships with corporate Human Resource partners.
- Recruited nontraditional students for the appropriate undergraduate or graduate degree programs.
- Served on curriculum development and marketing committees for new degree program.

PRIOR INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

VICTORY BEAUTY SYSTEMS, INC.

Chicago, Illinois

Director, Human Resources

Formed Human Resource department for 300+ employee operation, including eighteen retail stores and distribution center.

- Developed and implemented all Human Resource policies and procedures.
- Recruited for all levels of personnel, including executive positions.
- Developed salary administration plan.
- Designed and administered employee performance appraisal system for managerial and hourly employees.

THE STANDARD REGISTER COMPANY, *a Fortune 500 company*

Human Resource Analyst

Dayton, Ohio Corporate Headquarters

- In-depth position analysis and assessment of human resources using progressive behavioral analysis techniques.
- Recruited and placed professional and managerial employees for corporate and manufacturing management positions.
- Facilitator for on-going training and development programs for management throughout the corporation.

Training Coordinator/Human Resource Generalist
York, Pennsylvania

York Plant

- Performed Human Resource generalist functions for 450-employee unionized printing plant.
- Performed needs analysis and developed training programs for management and supervisory skills, customer service, and numerous office and plant positions.
- Managed plant safety program.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- **Indiana Commission of Higher Education**
 Selected to serve three-year term for Indiana Core Transfer Library Review Panel for Business/Management
- **ACBSP Co-Champion, Accreditation Council for Business Schools and Programs**
 Represent college at regional and national business meetings.
- **Campus Compact**
 Participate in symposiums to support faculty, staff, and students pursuing community based scholarship and action in the service of public good
- **SHRM, Society Human Resource Management**
- **NIHRA, Northeast Indiana Human Resource Association (local chapter of SHRM)**
 Serve on College Relations Committee
- **Co-advisor, SHRM Student Chapter, Indiana-Purdue University Fort Wayne 2012-13**

- **Thoreau Society member**

PRESENTATIONS

- **Consortium of Illinois Learning Communities (CILC) Best Practices Symposium: April 2015**
Presentation: *Show me the Water: A Learning Community Service- Learning Project*
- **Northeast Indiana Paralegal Association, February 2012**
Presentation: *Managing the Difficult*
- **Purdue University Fort Wayne, November 2011**
Organizational Leadership Graduate Program Capstone: Panelist, *Leading HR*

COMMUNITY SERVICE

- **Junior Achievement of Northeast Indiana**
Educational mentor and JA Finance park volunteer partner
- **Community Harvest Food Bank Volunteer**
- **Study Connection Volunteer, Fort Wayne Community Schools**
- **American Heart Association Volunteer**